

The Questions of the Noble Ratnacūḍa: A Mahāyāna Sūtra

Āryaratnacūḍaparipṛcchā nāma mahāyānasūtra · Toh 91 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་གཙུག་ན་རྒྱུ་པོ་ཆོས་ཞུ་པ།

The Questions of the Noble Ratnacūḍa, known in Sanskrit as the Āryaratna-cūḍa-paripṛcchā and in Tibetan as Phags pa gtsug na rin po ches zhus pa, is a Mahāyāna sūtra in which the bodhisattva Ratnacūḍa poses questions to the Buddha, who is depicted teaching on Vulture Peak near Rājagṛha before a vast assembly of monks and bodhisattvas. The text belongs to the celebrated Great Jewel Heap collection, the Ratnakūṭa, a large anthology of Mahāyāna sūtras, of which this discourse forms the forty-seventh chapter. It is catalogued as Toh 91 in the Kangyur, where it is preserved among the sūtra texts of that collection.

From the noble Great Jewel Heap, the collection of Dharma teachings in one hundred thousand chapters, this is the forty-seventh chapter: the Questions of the Noble Ratnacūḍa. First fascicle.

In the language of India: Āryaratna-cūḍa-paripṛcchā nāma mahāyāna sūtra.

In the Tibetan language: the sūtra of the Great Vehicle called "The Questions of the Noble Ratnacūḍa."

Homage to all buddhas, bodhisattvas, śrāvakas, and pratyekabuddhas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling on Vulture Peak Mountain near Rājagṛha, together with a great Saṅgha of forty-two thousand monks. All of them were arhats — their defilements exhausted, their afflictions extinguished, possessed of mastery, supremely liberated in mind, supremely liberated in wisdom, knowers of all that is to be known, great elephants, those who had done what needed to be done, accomplished their task, laid down their burden, attained their own benefit, utterly exhausted all bonds to continued existence, their minds supremely liberated through perfect knowing — each and every one of them gone entirely beyond to the supreme mastery over all sentient beings.

Also gathered together were eighty-four thousand bodhisattvas assembled from the buddha-fields of the ten directions, all of them bound by just one more birth, having received empowerment, arisen from the meditative absorption of heroic advance, having fully attained the meditative absorption

of the supreme lotus, firmly abiding in the meditative absorption of the vajra maṇḍala, sporting freely in the meditative absorption of the victory banner's crest ornament, thoroughly comprehending the vajra-like meditative absorption, fully settled in the meditative absorption of the array of the source of qualities, all buddha-qualities fully manifest to them, deeply inclined toward the heart of awakening, utterly transcendent over all the domains of Māra, firmly established in the abode of the buddha-domain, having fully attained the dhāraṇī of inexhaustible teaching, fully endowed with the eloquence that satisfies the faculties of all sentient beings, skilled in subduing all assemblies with the fearless bearing of a lion, prophesying with meaningful words through the power of teaching that remains effective until the end of time, beautifully adorned with the excellent marks of form, thoroughly defeating the forces of hostile assemblies that come to contend, their fame and the sound of their renown resounding high throughout the ten directions, praised, extolled, and deeply honored by all the buddhas, arisen from the immeasurable perfections of generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, wisdom, and skillful means, who had trained with supreme thoroughness across incalculable hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of eons, who thoroughly understood the disease of afflictions in all sentient beings and administered the medicine of Dharma to each as was appropriate, who entered into the profound and unfathomable phenomena arising from conditions, having thoroughly abandoned the views of the extreme and the non-extreme, and of eternalism and annihilation, their intention utterly purified — virtuous, stainless, and of supreme aspiration — skilled in the ways of ripening all sentient beings, of gathering them, of fully knowing them, and of truly understanding them, masters over their own minds, courageous and firm, unbreakable as a vajra, endowed with the power of faith, diligence, mindfulness, meditative absorption, and wisdom, fully entered upon the ten powers, dhāraṇīs, and aspirational prayers, their intelligence regarding immeasurable qualities and primordial wisdom equal to the expanse of space.

Among these were the following: the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara called Viśva-dṛṣṭi ("All-seeing"); Nityavilokin ("Ever-gazing"); Avalokiteśvara the Sovereign; Mahāsthāmaprāpta ("Attained Great Power"); Siṃha ("Lion"); Siṃhamati ("Lion-Minded"); Siṃhavikrāntagāmin ("One Who Advances with a Lion's Stride"); Siṃhaghoṣanirghosa ("Proclaimer of the Resounding Lion's Roar");

Paramātibuddhi ("Supreme Intelligence"); Vajrabuddhi ("Vajra Intelligence"); Vajrapramardhin ("Crusher by the Vajra"); Vajradhvaja ("Vajra Banner"); Vajrasena ("Vajra Host"); Acalavikrāntagāmin ("One Who Advances with Unwavering Strides"); Trailokyavikrāntagāmin ("One Who Strides Across the Three Worlds"); Sunetra ("Fine-Eyed"); Padmanetra ("Lotus-Eyed"); Padmavyūha ("Lotus Array"); Ratnavyūha ("Jewel Array"); Mahāpratibhāna ("Great Eloquence"); Mahātejas ("Great Might"); Ratnakūṭa ("Jewel Summit"); Ratnākara ("Jewel Source"); Ratnāmudrāhasta ("Precious Seal in Hand"); Guṇarājaprabhāsa ("Radiance of the King of Qualities"); Vyūharājaprabhāsa ("Radiance of the King of Arrays"); Vyūharāja ("King of Arrays"); Manovikrāntagāmin ("Subduer of the Two Minds"); Vidyullokamaṇḍita ("Adorned with the Light of Lightning"); Ākāśagarbha ("Treasury of Space"); Suvara ("Melodious Voice"); Meghasvara ("Cloud-Voice"); Dundubhisvara ("Drum-Voice"); Viśuddhasvara ("Pure Voice"); Viśuddhabuddhi ("Pure Intelligence"); and Bhadrāpāla and the other sixteen holy beings; Mañjuśrī and the other sixty incomparable bodhisattvas; Gandhahastī and the other thirty-two pure sentient beings; and Maitreya and all the others — all of them without exception were bodhisattvas, great beings of the Fortunate Aeon.

Also present were the divine son Mārajit ("Victor over Māra"); the divine son Kuśalavyūha ("Virtuous Array"); the divine son Sīmārāja; Bhadrarāja ("King of Excellence"); Jayanta; Jayantabuddhi ("Victorious Intelligence"); the sovereign who is utterly tranquil and tamed; the divine son Susaṃmata ("Well-Regarded"); and all the rest — twenty thousand divine sons who had genuinely entered the Great Vehicle; the four great kings; Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods); Brahmā, lord of the Akaniṣṭha realm; the divine son the caravan-leader; the divine son Maheśvara — together with these and many other gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (Skt. gandharva), asuras, garuḍas (Skt. garuḍa), kiṃnaras (Skt. kiṃnara), mahoragas (Skt. mahoraga), humans, and non-humans as well.

Then the Blessed One, seated upon a great ornate lion throne, surveyed the assembly of a hundred thousand surrounding him and taught the Dharma: he roared like a lion, he blazed like the sun, he shone cool like the moon, he burned like a lamp, he rang out like Śakra, he gleamed like Brahmā, and, rising like Mount Meru from the midst of the great ocean, he went into the midst of the great assembly and taught the Dharma — a holy life, wholesome at the beginning, wholesome in the middle, wholesome at the end, excellent in meaning, excellent in word, unmixed, perfectly complete, perfectly pure,

perfectly refined. Specifically, beginning from the Dharma-gateway called "The Pure Conduct of Bodhisattvas," he fully and correctly taught how bodhisattvas, great beings, come to engage in the pure conduct of a bodhisattva.

Then at that very time, beyond ninety-two hundred thousand buddha-fields to the east, there was a world-system called Supranirmita ("Well-Fashioned"). In that realm there currently dwelt, lived, and taught the Dharma a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, named Supraṭiṣṭhitaviśuddha ("Supremely Pure and Established"). From that buddha's presence, the bodhisattva, the great being named Ratnakūṭa, together with eight thousand bodhisattvas, surrounded and preceded by hundreds of thousands of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-humans,

disappeared from the world-system Supranirmita and came to be present here in this world-system of Endurance (Sahā). There, dwelling in the realm of Brahmā, he covered the entire great trichiliocosm with a single jeweled parasol, and with many flowers of various hues and manifold colors he covered the entire great trichiliocosm. Then, remaining in that very realm of Brahmā, he spoke these verses:

He who bore boundless suffering with patience,
And through firm and steadfast conduct perfected awakening —
The great sage Śākyamuni, beholden by all —
By gods and humans alike is this excellent finding found.

As many bodhisattvas as there are grains of sand in the Gaṅgā,
By the power of their diligence have been left behind,
Yet he tamed māras by the tens of millions
And attained dustless, sorrowless awakening.

He who is venerated as the sovereign of all beings —
From the supreme world-system in the eastern quarter,
Supranirmita, with utterly pure conduct,
From that Victor's presence I have come here.

Those who wish to hear the words of Dharma,
To behold the bodhisattvas of the ten directions,
And who desire to see as well that Foremost of Bipeds —
Let them make haste to Vulture Peak!

A guide is supremely difficult to find and behold;
The peaceful Dharma too is supremely difficult to hear;
A precious human birth of leisure and endowment is supremely difficult to find;
Moral discipline and faith too are ever difficult to find.

While a world-guide still abides among you,
Whoever, longing for happiness, does not accumulate merit —
What shall he do once nirvāṇa has come and gone?
Such a one should go to the presence of that Victor.

All those who have abandoned every lower realm,
Who obtain happiness among gods and humans,
And who desire to attain nirvāṇa and become blissful —
Let them go to the presence of that peerless one.

He is the king of physicians, bestowing the nectar of immortality;
He is the foremost navigator, showing the supreme path;
He is the Dharma-king, holding the precious and holy;
He is the support and stronghold of all sentient beings.

Then, through the bodhisattva, the great being Ratnakūṭa, proclaiming these accomplished verses, the entire great trichiliocosm resounded with a harmonious sound. The venerable Śāradvatīputra (Śāriputra) heard these verses and, having heard them, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, from where have these verses of such profound meaning come?"

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, to the east of this buddha-field, beyond nine hundred and ninety-two hundred thousand buddha-fields, there is a world-system called Supranirmita. There a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha named Supraṭiṣṭhitaviśuddha currently dwells, lives, and teaches the Dharma. From that buddha's presence, the bodhisattva, the great being named Ratnakūṭa, accompanied by eight thousand bodhisattvas, has come here in order to behold me, to pay homage, and to render service — and also to behold these great bodhisattvas gathered here from the ten directions. Surrounded and preceded by hundreds of thousands of many gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-humans, they are beating drums, showering down rains of flowers, sending forth rays of light, causing the entire great trichiliocosm to tremble, and, by the great power of the bodhisattva,

making those world systems that had been beautifully conjured by the great supernatural power of the bodhisattva vanish from sight, they arrived in this world system of Endurance (Sahā). There, Śāriputra, the bodhisattva, the great being Ratnakūṭa, in order to rouse those sentient beings who were heedless, remained in the Brahmā world and spoke these verses. Śāriputra, by making those verses resound throughout the great trichiliocosm, he caused countless sentient beings to give rise to roots of virtue.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Ratnakūṭa, together with those eight thousand bodhisattvas, surrounded and preceded by hundreds of thousands of many gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-humans, beat the drums, showered down rains of flowers, sent forth rays of light, caused the entire great trichiliocosm to tremble, and, by the great power of the bodhisattva and the great supernatural power of the bodhisattva, came to where the Blessed One was and arrived there. Having arrived, they bowed their heads to the feet of the Blessed One in homage, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and then took their seats in the presence of the Blessed One — that great being and all those many hundreds of thousands of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-humans together with him.

Having taken his seat to one side, the bodhisattva Ratnakūṭa then spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, one who abides in utter purity — Blessed One, are your troubles few, your distress little, are you at ease, living well, abiding in strength and comfort?" Thus he made his inquiry of the Blessed One's health.

"Blessed One, I too have come here in order to hear the perfectly pure conduct of the bodhisattvas, the great beings. Blessed One, I request that the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, please teach well that perfectly pure conduct of the bodhisattvas — that conduct in which, if bodhisattvas abide, they will come to be supremely accomplished, supremely perfected, at ease, and in possession of thorough purity; in which all the afflictions that would link them to the bonds of habitual tendency will not arise at all; in which, by their own perfectly pure conduct, they will be able to thoroughly explore the mental conduct of all sentient beings; in which they will come to understand precisely and correctly the defining characteristics of conduct; in which, by conduct imbued with gnosis, they will purify the conduct of attachment, aversion, and delusion; in which, by conduct in accordance with

the Dharma, they will inspire those sentient beings who abide in discordant conduct to delight in diligent application to the true Dharma; in which they will be blameless before all Tathāgatas; in which all sentient beings will be sustained; in which all māras will find no opening against them; in which they will behold all the buddhas presently arisen throughout the ten directions without any obstruction to their vision; and in which all their conduct will be known by the gnosis-conduct of the Tathāgata."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One addressed the bodhisattva, the great being Ratnakūṭa, with these words:

"Son of good family, therefore listen well and take it to heart, for I shall explain just a few examples of the pure conduct of bodhisattvas, great beings."

"Excellent, Blessed One," said the bodhisattva Ratnakūṭa, and he listened attentively to the Blessed One. Then the Blessed One spoke to him these words:

"Son of good family, the pure conduct of bodhisattvas, great beings, is fourfold. What are the four? They are as follows: the pure conduct of the perfections; the pure conduct of the Dharmas conducive to awakening; the pure conduct of accomplishing the superknowledges; and the pure conduct of ripening sentient beings. Son of good family, these four are the pure conduct of bodhisattvas.

Of these, the pure conduct of the perfections is to be thoroughly understood as skill in the wisdom of universal dedication. The pure conduct of the Dharmas conducive to awakening is to be thoroughly understood as skill in the wisdom that teaches the path. The pure conduct of accomplishing the superknowledges is to be thoroughly understood as skill in the wisdom of making the mind workable in meditative concentration. The pure conduct of ripening sentient beings is to be thoroughly understood as skill in the wisdom of stabilizing the superior intention through great compassion.

Son of good family, what is the pure conduct of the perfections for bodhisattvas? It is the pure conduct of the six perfections. What are those six? They are: the perfections of generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom.

Son of good family, what is the pure conduct of the perfection of generosity for bodhisattvas? It is this: to dispel the mind entangled in the stain of miserliness, and to increase the mind that follows upon giving; then, having removed the stain of miserliness and resting in the mind of giving, to rest in the mind of

giving away all one's possessions completely.

When one gives in this way, one does not make four distinctions. What are the four? One does not distinguish between sentient beings, does not distinguish between phenomena, does not distinguish in one's dedication, and does not distinguish in one's intention.

How is it that one does not distinguish between sentient beings? It is by not thinking: 'To this one I shall give, to that one I shall not give; to this one I shall give much, to that one I shall give little; to this one I shall give something good, to that one I shall give something inferior; to this one I shall give always, to that one I shall not give always; to this one I shall give with respect, to that one I shall give without respect; to this one I shall give everything, to that one I shall not give everything; this one is virtuous, this one is not virtuous; this one is a proper recipient of generosity, this one is not a proper recipient; if I give to this one my giving will become perfectly pure, if I give to that one it will not become pure; this one is rightly engaged, this one is wrongly engaged.' Son of good family, thus one who abandons the distraction of such thoughts and becomes one of evenness, of non-distinction, of neither high nor low, who applies an equal mind to all sentient beings, who gives equally, loves equally, has compassion equally, who makes no distinctions and has become like space — that is called not distinguishing between sentient beings.

How is it that one does not distinguish between phenomena? To all those who are to become teachers of Dharma, one gives —"

one does not give rise to the thought, "I will not give to those who will speak what is not the Dharma." Rather, having attained the evenness of all phenomena, one gives. One does not give with the thought, "ordinary beings are inferior"; one does not give with the thought, "noble ones are of great breadth." Instead, because the dharmadhātu is by its intrinsic nature even and without distinction, one gives — and this is called not distinguishing between phenomena.

How is it that one does not make distinctions in dedication? When one gives, the root of virtue thereby generated is not dedicated toward obtaining the rank of Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), nor toward obtaining Brahmā, nor toward kingship, nor toward becoming a merchant, a householder, toward form, wealth, prosperity, or retinue. That root of virtue is not dedicated toward birth-places of death and rebirth throughout all the destinies of existence. It is not dedicated toward the vehicle of the śrāvakas, nor toward the vehicle of the

pratyekabuddhas. Rather, those roots of virtue are dedicated to nothing other than unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening — and this is called not making distinctions in dedication.

How is it that one does not make distinctions of intention when giving? One gives with an even intention, with even engagement, without expectation of karmic maturation, without expectation of recompense from others, without deceit, without pretense — giving wholeheartedly and with a mind of thorough relinquishment, without regret — and having attained faith in the three times before giving, while giving, and having attained supreme faith after giving. This is called not making distinctions of intention.

Son of good family, in this way a bodhisattva who gives does not make these four distinctions. This is the first purified limb of the perfection of generosity for bodhisattvas.

Furthermore, one gives with eight purified views. What are those eight? They are: giving with a view of self thoroughly purified, and likewise with a view of sentient being thoroughly purified, with a view of life-force thoroughly purified, with a view of person thoroughly purified, with a view of annihilation thoroughly purified, with a view of permanence thoroughly purified, with a view of arising thoroughly purified, and with a view of perishing thoroughly purified. One gives with those eight views thoroughly purified.

Furthermore, one gives having thoroughly abandoned the four latent tendencies (*vāsanās*). What are the four? The latent tendency of the phenomena of ordinary beings, the latent tendency of the phenomena of śrāvakas, the latent tendency of the phenomena of pratyekabuddhas, and the latent tendency of the conjunction of habitual imprints. One gives having thoroughly abandoned those four latent tendencies.

Furthermore, one gives having thoroughly abandoned the four perceptions. What are the four? The perception of permanence, the perception of pleasure, the perception of purity, and the perception of self. One gives having thoroughly abandoned those four perceptions.

Furthermore, one gives with four modes thoroughly purified. What are the four? Thoroughly purified body, thoroughly purified speech, thoroughly purified mind, and thoroughly purified intention. One gives with those four modes thoroughly purified.

Furthermore, one gives having thoroughly transcended three attachments. What are the three? Attachment to karmic maturation, attachment to regret, and attachment to dedicating toward the Lesser Vehicle. One gives having thoroughly transcended those three.

Furthermore, one gives having thoroughly transcended three fears. What are the three? The fear of excessive pride, the fear of conceit, and the fear of the deeds of Māra. One gives having thoroughly transcended those three.

Furthermore, one gives sealed with four seals. What are the four? Sealed with the emptiness of the inner,

sealed with the emptiness of the outer, sealed with the emptiness of sentient beings, and sealed with the emptiness of awakening. One gives sealed with those four seals.

Furthermore, one gives inseparable from four applications of diligence. What are the four? The application of diligence to satisfy all sentient beings, the application of diligence to perfect all buddha qualities, the application of diligence to fully complete the major marks and excellent minor features, and the application of diligence to purify buddha fields. One gives inseparable from those four applications of diligence.

Furthermore, one gives inseparable from four mindfulnesses. What are the four? Mindfulness of the awakening mind, mindfulness of beholding the buddhas, mindfulness of great loving-kindness, and mindfulness of abandoning the afflictions of all sentient beings. One gives inseparable from those four mindfulnesses.

Furthermore, one gives with the three spheres thoroughly pure. What are the three? The thorough purity of the sphere of self, the thorough purity of the sphere of sentient beings, and the thorough purity of the sphere of awakening. One gives with those three spheres thoroughly pure.

Furthermore, one gives thoroughly purified by four thorough purities of understanding. What are the four? The thorough purity of understanding generosity, the thorough purity of understanding how to satisfy the intentions of sentient beings, the thorough purity of understanding that discriminates phenomena as illusion-like, and the thorough purity of understanding that discriminates dedication. One gives thoroughly purified by those four thorough purities of understanding.

O son of good family, when a bodhisattva who has entered into such Dharma practices in this way, his conduct in the perfection of generosity becomes thoroughly and supremely pure. O son of good family, this is the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of generosity.

O son of good family, what then is the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of moral discipline? O son of good family, the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of moral discipline has one aspect. What is that one aspect? It is this: the awakening mind — a mind without equal, a mind unshared by others, a mind supremely distinguished above all three worlds, a mind that overwhelms all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, a mind that tames all māras, a mind that utterly exhausts all obscurations of karma and affliction, a mind that liberates all sentient beings, a mind that is the very self of all immeasurable precious qualities — not abandoning that mind, but guarding it, nurturing it, and never forgetting it. O son of good family, this is one aspect of the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of moral discipline.

O son of good family, furthermore, the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of moral discipline has two aspects. What are the two? They are these: radiating unobstructed light toward all sentient beings, and then introducing those very sentient beings to the moral discipline of the intention for awakening. These are the two aspects.

O son of good family, the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of moral discipline has three aspects. What are the three? They are these: thoroughly purifying the body by removing all physical wrongdoings, so that the body becomes thoroughly pure; thoroughly purifying speech by removing all faults of speech — flattery, divisive talk, and verbal wrongs of every kind — so that speech becomes thoroughly pure; and removing desire, ill-will, and

removing the conceptuality of harm, so that the mind becomes thoroughly pure. These are the three aspects.

O son of good family, the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of moral discipline has four aspects. What are the four? They are these: taking up the trainings correctly; not letting the trainings that have been correctly taken up deteriorate; bringing to full maturity those sentient beings who have broken their moral discipline; and revering those who are endowed with moral discipline as one would revere a teacher. These are the

four aspects.

O son of good family, the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of moral discipline has five aspects. What are the five? They are these: not praising oneself; not disparaging others; not disdainning those who are untrained; not placing one's hopes in the mind of a śrāvaka; and not desiring the vehicle of the pratyekabuddha. These are the five aspects.

O son of good family, the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of moral discipline has six aspects. What are the six? They are these: by not transgressing the trainings, recollecting the buddhas; by being without remorse concerning moral discipline, recollecting the Dharma; by looking to the training of the buddhas, recollecting the Saṅgha; by completely abandoning all afflictions, recollecting generosity; by not abiding in any birth whatsoever, recollecting moral discipline; and by bringing all virtuous qualities to complete fulfillment, recollecting the gods. These are the six aspects.

O son of good family, the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of moral discipline has seven aspects. What are the seven? They are these: having devotion to all the qualities of the buddhas; taking oneself as witness and having a sense of personal shame; having made all buddhas directly present, possessing a sense of shame before others; being respectful through absence of pride; being resolute through causing no distress to oneself or others; being harmless by viewing with fear the moral failings of the next world; and holding no resentment through the subsiding of mental torment. These are the seven aspects.

O son of good family, the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of moral discipline has eight aspects. What are the eight? They are these: not assuming a moral demeanor with a mind tainted by material gain; being without hypocrisy by relinquishing all clinging; not measuring oneself against what one has received, being naturally content; fully completing the right holding of the noble lineage by clothing oneself in cultivated virtue and requisites; not caring for the body by continuously maintaining residence in solitude; not caring for one's life by holding fast to the sacred Dharma; delighting in solitude by abandoning crowds; and being devoted to the joy of Dharma by fearing the entirety of the three realms. These are the eight aspects.

O son of good family, the thorough purity of the bodhisattva's conduct in the perfection of moral discipline has nine aspects. What are the nine? They are

these: taming the nine factors of the resentful mind; thoroughly transcending the nine stations of sentient beings; completely purifying the root of the nine successively abiding absorptions; having a calm mind through freedom from mental torment; seeking out the full complement of calm abiding because the mind is workable; being unwavering by thoroughly transcending deterioration in ritual conduct, moral discipline, and view; being free of deception toward all sentient beings by completely fulfilling the Great Vehicle; being utterly perfected by having blameless moral discipline; and having a grateful mind by being skilled in dedication. These are the nine aspects.

O son of noble lineage, the perfection of moral discipline of a bodhisattva — the practice that is wholly pure — has ten aspects. What are these ten aspects? They are as follows: the complete purification of the three actions of body; the complete purification of the four actions of speech; the complete purification of the three actions of mind; possessing an intention free of deceitfulness and trickery, being upright and without pretense; non-contradiction with all the trainings; leading others onward through things that are forerunners to beneficial engagement; having a mind that is not reckless, by virtue of the ground of taming and vigilance; becoming the teacher of all sentient beings by practicing oneself what one teaches; bowing down and prostrating at places of generosity through being free of pride; and placing Dharma foremost in one's very life-force while not placing worldly material things foremost. These are the ten aspects.

O son of noble lineage, furthermore the bodhisattvas' practice of the perfection of moral discipline that is wholly pure has two aspects. What are these two aspects? They are as follows: the moral discipline that is marked and effortful — never to be abandoned even for the sake of one's life; and the moral discipline that is unmarked and spontaneously accomplished — training in not superimposing anything onto all phenomena. These are the two aspects.

O son of noble lineage, furthermore the bodhisattva's practice of the perfection of moral discipline that is wholly pure has two aspects. What are these two? They are as follows: through inner purity, the sense bases are purified; and through outer purity, all sense objects are abandoned.

O son of noble lineage, furthermore the bodhisattva's practice of the perfection of moral discipline that is wholly pure has two aspects. What are these two? They are as follows: dedicating everything toward awakening, by means of the defining characteristic that is awakening's essential nature; and

the defining characteristic of pure moral discipline, which is non-grasping at signs. These are those two.

O son of noble lineage, this is the bodhisattva's practice of the perfection of moral discipline that is wholly pure.

O son of noble lineage, in this regard, what is the bodhisattva's practice of the perfection of patience that is wholly pure? O son of noble lineage, in this: a bodhisattva, through the complete purification of speech, when reviled will not revile in return. Through the complete purification of body, when struck will not strike in return. Through the complete purification of mind, when angered will not become angry in return. Through the complete purification of superior intention, when burned will not burn in return.

O son of noble lineage, furthermore, a bodhisattva, out of regard for sentient beings, will not revile even when others speak ill of them or when they hear the road of harsh words directed at them. Out of regard for the world beyond, when struck by hands, clods of earth, or sticks, they do not become angry. In order to always safeguard awakening, even when limbs and extremities are cut off, they do not become angry.

O son of noble lineage, furthermore, a bodhisattva, in order to fully embrace the four means of attraction, does not revile those who beg from them. In order to establish those beings on firm ground through the path of awakening, they cultivate loving-kindness toward them. In order to perfectly fulfill their aspiration prayers, they arouse compassion toward them. In order to abandon all the works of Māra and all afflictions, whatever beggar may come, they regard that person with a mind of benefit and with compassion, and they unflinchingly give what is determined to be a factor of awakening.

O son of noble lineage, furthermore, a bodhisattva, in order to perfectly complete the body of a buddha, recollects buddhas and bears it with patience. In order to perfectly complete the ten powers, they recollect awakening and bear it with patience. In order to perfectly complete the vision of primordial wisdom free of attachment to the three times, they recollect primordial wisdom and bear it with patience.

In order to perfectly complete great loving-kindness, they recollect the wish to benefit and bear it with patience. In order to perfectly complete great compassion, they recollect the overpowering of what has a result and bear it with patience. In order to perfectly complete fearlessness, they recollect the lion's posture and bear it with patience. In order to bow before all sentient

beings, they recollect that the crown of the head is not seen and bear it with patience. In order not to be overwhelmed by the entire world, they recollect the major and minor marks of excellence and bear it with patience. In order to taste the wisdom of omniscience, they recollect all the qualities of a buddha and bear it with patience.

O son of noble lineage, the patience of a bodhisattva is perfectly purified by two powers. What are these two? They are the power of individual discernment and the power of meditation. Of these, the patience that rests upon body and mind is the power of individual discernment. The patience that rests upon all phenomena is the power of meditation.

O son of noble lineage, furthermore, the perfectly purified conduct of the perfection of patience of a bodhisattva is this: bearing patience toward all sentient beings through the understanding of selflessness, and bearing patience toward all phenomena through understanding their utter solitude. Whatever cannot be endured among all phenomena — that is perfectly purified patience. Why so? Because in the ultimate sense there is no phenomenon whatsoever that is either endured or not endured. The patience of one who does not assert any phenomena at all is perfectly purified patience; for one who asserts phenomena, there is no perfectly purified patience whatsoever. The patience of one who has no timidity before any phenomena whatsoever is perfectly purified patience; for one who is timid, there is no perfectly purified patience whatsoever. The patience of one who grasps at no phenomena whatsoever is perfectly purified patience; for one who grasps, there is no perfectly purified patience whatsoever. The patience of one for whom there is no self, no sentient being, and no phenomenon is perfectly purified patience; for one who abides in self, sentient beings, and phenomena, there is no perfectly purified patience whatsoever.

O son of noble lineage, furthermore, the perfectly purified conduct of the perfection of patience of a bodhisattva is twofold. What are these two? They are: perfectly purified patience with respect to the magical transformations of the body, and perfectly purified patience with respect to all phenomena just as they are. Those are the two.

O son of noble lineage, this is the perfectly purified conduct of the perfection of patience of a bodhisattva.

O son of noble lineage, as for what constitutes the perfectly purified conduct of the perfection of diligence of a bodhisattva — it is this: not abandoning the

awakening mind; having no timidity in the face of what is necessary and what is not necessary; not growing weary through exertion; not being faint-hearted in gathering the roots of virtue; not turning back from these perfections; striving to seek out all phenomena thoroughly; undertaking to teach all phenomena; being delighted in thoroughly upholding all phenomena; liberating beings from great sacrifice; never growing weary of bringing all sentient beings to full maturation; coursing through buddha-fields; utterly transcending the Lesser Vehicle; fulfilling all previously made solemn pledges; gathering generosity, ethical conduct, learning, and similar qualities; not wasting the merit accumulated in the past; and, free of pride, rendering service to all sentient beings in every respect. This is called the perfection of diligence.

As for its perfect purification — it consists in knowing the body to be like a reflection and an image; knowing speech to be inexpressible; knowing the mind to be utterly and closely at peace; discerning the knowledge of exhaustion clearly; understanding the knowledge of exhaustion thoroughly; and decisively realizing the knowledge of non-arising. One undertakes diligence in order to be liberated from three kinds of exertion:

What are the three? They are: exertion that is based on a fixed station; exertion that is based on an object; and exertion that is based on conceptual elaboration. Those are the three. One undertakes diligence as non-attachment to three kinds of attachment. What are the three? Non-attachment to the eye, to form, and to eye-consciousness; non-attachment to the ear, to sound, and to ear-consciousness; non-attachment to the nose, to smell, and to nose-consciousness; non-attachment to the tongue, to taste, and to tongue-consciousness; non-attachment to the body, to tactile objects, and to body-consciousness; and non-attachment to the mind, to mental phenomena, and to mind-consciousness.

Endowed with diligence that neither grasps nor rejects, one neither takes up generosity nor casts aside miserliness; neither takes up moral discipline nor casts aside corrupt ethical conduct; neither takes up patience nor casts aside ill will; neither takes up diligence nor casts aside laziness; neither takes up meditative concentration nor casts aside distraction; neither takes up wisdom nor casts aside corrupt wisdom; neither takes up virtue nor casts aside non-virtue; neither takes up the awakening of a buddha nor casts aside the awakening of a śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha.

By neither taking up nor rejecting in this way, one comes to be endowed with diligence that is the perfect purification of two things. What are the two? The arising of objects from inner activation, and consciousness following after external signs — these are called the two. What is the perfect purification of these two? It is the inner pacification whereby one does not move outward, and the absence of conceptual elaboration. This is called the perfect purification of the two.

Not moving and free of conceptual elaboration — this diligence free of conceptual elaboration is the perfectly purified conduct of the bodhisattva's perfection of diligence.

Noble son, what then is the perfectly purified conduct of the bodhisattva's perfection of meditative concentration? It is the correct accomplishment and thorough completion of the constituent factors of meditative concentration, followed by individual examination, and then, having individually investigated, entering into equipoise. Though one meditates in this way, one abides in form and yet does not meditate with form as object; though one meditates, it is not feeling, not perception, not formations — one abides in consciousness and does not meditate with consciousness as object. Though one meditates, one abides in the eye and does not meditate with the eye as object; though one meditates, one abides in the ear and does not meditate with the ear as object; not the nose, not the tongue, not the body — one abides in the mind and does not meditate with the mind as object. Though one meditates, one abides in form and does not meditate with form as object; not sound, not smell, not taste, not tactile objects — one abides in mental phenomena and does not meditate with mental phenomena as object. Though one meditates, one abides in conceptuality regarding the body and does not meditate with that as object; though one meditates, one abides in conceptuality regarding the mind and does not meditate with that as object. Though one meditates, one abides in earth and does not meditate with earth as object; likewise not water, not fire, not wind — one abides in space and does not meditate with space as object. Though one meditates, not the moon, not the sun, not Śakra (Indra), not Brahmā — one abides in the Lord of Creatures and does not meditate with the Lord of Creatures as object. One abides in the desire realm and does not meditate with the desire realm as object; not the form realm — one abides in the formless realm and does not meditate with the formless realm as object. Though one meditates, one abides in this world and does not meditate with this world as object; one abides in the other world and does not meditate with

the other world as object. Though one meditates, one abides in what is neither high nor low and, remaining unmoved, meditates. Though one meditates, one abides in the view of a self-appropriating self and does not meditate with that as object. Though one meditates, not sentient being, not life-force, not nourisher, not person, not one born from a seed —

not one born from a seed — one abides in the view of a self-appropriating son and does not meditate with that as object. Though one meditates, one has accepted the view of annihilation and does not meditate with that as object. Though one meditates, not the view of permanence, not the view of arising, but having accepted the view of cessation, one does not meditate with that as object. Though one meditates, one does not meditate for the sake of utterly exhausting the defilements. Though one meditates, one does not meditate for the sake of entering the faultless and directly realizing the fruit. Though one meditates, one does not meditate for the sake of not overly appropriating. Though one meditates for the sake of becoming familiar with the meditative absorption of emptiness, one does not meditate for the sake of directly realizing the meditative absorption of emptiness. Though one meditates for the sake of becoming familiar with the signless meditative absorption, one does not meditate for the sake of directly realizing the signless meditative absorption. Though one meditates for the sake of becoming familiar with the wishless meditative absorption, one does not meditate for the sake of directly realizing the wishless meditative absorption. One meditates having established oneself in the armor of great loving-kindness and the blessing of great compassion, actualizing the aspect of emptiness endowed with the supreme of all aspects. And what is that emptiness endowed with the supreme of all aspects? It is an emptiness in which generosity is without lack, moral discipline is without lack, patience is without lack, diligence is without lack, meditative concentration is without lack, wisdom is without lack, skillful means is without lack, loving-kindness is without lack, compassion, joy, and equanimity are without lack, entry into the knowledge of the truths is without lack, the awakening mind in viewing sentient beings is without lack, the application of intention and superior intention is without lack, generosity and pleasing speech and purposeful activity and consonance of aim are without lack, mindfulness and vigilance are without lack, the establishments of mindfulness, the thorough abandonments, the bases of miraculous power, the faculties, the powers, the limbs of awakening, and the noble eightfold path are without lack, calm abiding and insight are without lack, generosity and taming

and perfect restraint and resoluteness are without lack, a sense of shame and a sense of propriety are without lack, one is not endowed with unwholesome phenomena, one is endowed with all wholesome phenomena, one is blessed by the unceasing stream of the ways of the buddhas, one is fully gathered by the blazing ways of the Dharma, one is endowed with the complete gathering of the ways of the Saṅgha, one is blessed by the regard for all sentient beings, one is well adorned by the complete accomplishment of the body of a buddha, one dedicates toward the complete perfection of the buddha-expanse, one is endowed with the equanimity of the meditative absorption of a buddha, one is endowed with the miraculous powers of a buddha and the individual perfect knowledges, one is perfectly upheld by the power of the ten powers, one is thoroughly established in the four fearlessnesses, one is in accord with the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha, one is unmixed with the vehicle of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, one has removed the afflictions that forge connections with habitual tendencies, one is inseparable from the wisdom of direct knowledge, one has obtained the four kinds of teaching in being a teacher to all sentient beings, one has obtained the equality of worldly and supramundane phenomena, one fully ripens all sentient beings without being reproached, one is straightforward, skillful, dispelling the suffering of all sentient beings, purifying all afflictions, liberating from the river, cutting through all grasping, naturally at peace, at peace with respect to all karma and afflictions —

equanimous through the nature of reality, beholding all the qualities of a buddha, without liberation through one's own defining characteristics so that the inert may be blessed, not giving scriptural transmission through one's own power, always striving in the activities of a buddha, cooled and refreshed through the nearness of peace, and always blazing with the activity of fully ripening sentient beings — this is called the emptiness endowed with the supreme of all aspects.

Son of good family, consider the following example. Imagine that all the sentient beings in the great trichiliocosm — as many as there are — have each been trained as painters skilled in different styles, each trained distinctly in different branches of the craft. Among them, some are skilled in drawing outlines but not skilled in sketching forms; some are skilled in finishing a composition but not skilled in the branches and sub-branches; some are skilled in sketching the arms and legs but not skilled in sketching the eyes, the head, and the ears. Now, son of good family, a king of royal lineage consecrates

them all with a head-sprinkling empowerment and presents them with a piece of cloth, saying: "Paint my likeness on this cloth, and let all of you together paint a picture on it." Then all those painters assemble and stretch out the cloth, but in the midst of them, one single painter has gone off to another region. When the remaining painters then paint the likeness of that king upon the cloth — son of good family, what do you think? If the work of that one absent painter has not been included, would that cloth be endowed with the supreme of all aspects?

He replied: Blessed One, it would not.

The Blessed One declared: Son of good family, this analogy has been given for the purpose of fully comprehending the meaning, and here the meaning is this. Son of good family, just as without that one painter the cloth would not be endowed with the supreme of all aspects, in the same way, son of good family, from among all those aspects, practices, and efforts through which the qualities of a buddha are perfectly accomplished, if even one single aspect is not taught, it is not the emptiness endowed with the supreme of all aspects. When all the qualities of a buddha have been truly and completely gathered through beholding, when one does not abide together with the arising of afflictions and with all conceptual elaborations that fixate upon signs — that is the bodhisattva's emptiness endowed with the supreme of all aspects.

When this teaching was definitively expounded, eight thousand bodhisattvas attained patient acceptance (Skt. *kṣānti*) with regard to the emptiness endowed with the supreme of all aspects.

Son of good family, this is the perfectly pure conduct of the bodhisattva's perfection of meditative concentration.

Son of good family, as to what constitutes the perfectly pure conduct of the bodhisattva's Perfection of Wisdom — son of good family, here the bodhisattva is endowed with the twelve aspects of perfectly pure wisdom. And what are these twelve aspects? They are as follows: with regard to the past limit, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis there without attachment and without obstruction; with regard to the future limit, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis there without attachment and without obstruction; with regard to the present, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis there without attachment and without obstruction; with regard to the conditioned, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis there without

attachment and without obstruction;

with regard to the unconditioned, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis there without attachment and without obstruction; with regard to all the worldly crafts and occupational arts, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis there without attachment and without obstruction; with regard to what transcends the world, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis there without attachment and without obstruction; with regard to the knowledge of dependent origination, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis there without attachment and without obstruction; with regard to the knowledge of the truths, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis there without attachment and without obstruction; with regard to the teaching of conventional truth, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis there without attachment and without obstruction; with regard to the teaching of ultimate truth, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis there without attachment and without obstruction; and, because the faculties and diligence of sentient beings differ, knowing all their superior, middling, and inferior faculties, whether supreme or not supreme, the bodhisattva enters into the seeing of wisdom and gnosis with respect to all sentient beings there without attachment and without obstruction.

That wisdom of the bodhisattva is noble and undefiled, transcendent of the world, in accord with the factors of penetrating discernment, in accord with the intentions of sentient beings, of unfathomable depth, difficult to see, profound and hard to penetrate, distinguishing and definitively realizing, free from views, purified of habitual tendencies, realizing the selflessness of the self in emptiness, in accord with the emptiness of all things, knowing the manner of the emptiness of phenomena, definitively realizing the meaning, extremely sharp, extremely refined, without any appearance, without contradiction, unobstructed, discerning the timely and the untimely, not transgressing the right moment, faultless, well guarded, taking delight in the faultless, penetrating the truths, realizing the truth of cessation, completely crossing over — blameless in all places — not engaging in solitary conduct, engaging in thorough conduct, engaging in the conduct of the minds of all sentient beings, turning away from the entire world and yet coming from nowhere, completely transcending all objects and yet not turning away from the domain of the buddhas, completely transcending all strivings and yet not turning away from the work of bringing all sentient beings to full maturity, completely

transcending all forms of conduct and yet not turning away from virtuous conduct, completely transcending all mental referents and yet not turning away from the conduct of the minds of all sentient beings, engaging in appropriation and yet blazing without appropriation, unstained by all worldly phenomena and yet not separated from the world, without a body and yet in accord with the conduct and intentions of all sentient beings.

That wisdom of the bodhisattva quickly penetrates the nature of things as they are, causes the faculties to ripen, strives without interruption throughout a long time and always in a continuous stream in wholesome phenomena, inclines toward the heart of awakening, blazes in the practice of giving virtue without appropriation, is blessed by all buddhas, tames all māras, satisfies all sentient beings, sees the gnosis of omniscience, realizes all meanings, finds all phenomena to be of equal taste, and is perfectly seized by all means of skillful means.

Son of good family, the Perfection of Wisdom is called the Perfection of Wisdom because it has gone beyond the far shore of existence and is immeasurable. It is called the Perfection of Wisdom because it has gone beyond all signs, all referents, and all the conduct of the minds of sentient beings.

The complete purification of that wisdom is twofold. What are the two? They are as follows: complete purification that has the characteristic of non-attachment, and

complete purification that has the characteristic of unobstructed wisdom. These, then, are the two complete purifications.

There are also another two complete purifications. What are the two? They are as follows: complete purification of the referent, and complete purification of the view. These are the two complete purifications.

That wisdom follows after all things, follows after sentient beings, and follows after phenomena. That wisdom is not re-engaged by any of the afflictions whatsoever, and yet it does engage every sphere of arising. That wisdom does not abide, and yet it abides in all objects and in the object-domain of omniscient gnosis. That wisdom is free from all extremes and does not dwell in any middle. That wisdom, by seeing clearly with unobstructed vision in all ten directions the unobstructed domain that arises, itself also obtains that which is unobstructed. That wisdom is the forerunner of knowing and realizing all phenomena. That wisdom is endowed with all the meanings of the Dharma,

yet it neither possesses them nor lacks them nor is separated from them — it cannot be expressed as either joined to or disjoined from any phenomenon whatsoever.

Son of good family, the bodhisattva's source of wisdom is the source of gnosis. It is the source of merit. It is the source of hearing. It is the source of qualities. It is the source of Dharma. It is the source of dhāraṇī and eloquence. It is the source of the individual perfect cognitions. It is the source endowed with the supreme of all qualities and gnosis in every aspect. Son of good family, this is the complete purification of the practice of the bodhisattva's Perfection of Wisdom.

When this chapter on the gate of the Dharma of the complete purification of the practice of the Perfection of Wisdom was taught, twenty-two thousand gods and living beings within that assembly gave rise to the mind oriented toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Eight thousand bodhisattvas attained patience with respect to phenomena that do not arise. Five hundred monks liberated their minds from the defilements without remainder. Ten thousand sons of the gods obtained the Dharma-eye — pure and stainless, free from dust, with regard to phenomena — and they spoke these words: "Blessed One, those sentient beings who will come to hear this chapter on the gate of the Dharma of the complete purification of the practice of the Perfection of Wisdom — if they have thereby fully seized all the buddha's qualities, then how much more need be said of those who, having heard it, have faith in it, take it up, hold it, read it, teach it, and practice it in accordance with suchness!"

The Second Fascicle.

Then the Blessed One spoke again to the great bodhisattva Ratnaśikhara: Son of good family, what is the complete purification of the practice of the qualities conducive to awakening for a bodhisattva? Son of good family, here the bodhisattva dwells in the close application of mindfulness that regards the body as body. He establishes mindfulness accompanied by discernment of the body in two aspects. What are those two aspects of discernment? They are as follows: discernment accompanied by the aspect of the unattractive, and discernment accompanied by the aspect of the attractive.

What is discernment accompanied by the aspect of the unattractive? It is this: "Alas, this body is impure — filled with filth, short-lived, and leading fools astray." This is discernment accompanied by the aspect of the unattractive.

What is discernment accompanied by the aspect of the attractive? It is this:

"By means of this body, impure and friendless, I shall attain the body of the Tathāgata — the dharmakāya, the body of merit, the body of wisdom, the vajra body, the indestructible body, the undefiled body, the body that is supremely exalted above the three worlds, the body whose very sight brings satisfaction to all sentient beings." This is discernment accompanied by the aspect of the attractive.

Noble son, this is the bodhisattva's cultivation of mindfulness of the body as body, established with discernment in two aspects.

Noble son, furthermore, when a bodhisattva cultivates the close establishment of mindfulness that regards the body as body, he purifies two things. What are those two? They are the aspect of impermanence and the aspect of permanence.

What is the aspect of impermanence? It is this: "Alas, this body is impermanent — it does not last long, and in the end there is death." Knowing this, one does not pursue a livelihood that is contrary to the Dharma for the body's sake, but instead takes hold of what is essential. One takes hold of three essentials: the essential of the body, the essential of wealth and resources, and the essential of livelihood. Thinking "the body is impermanent," one takes it upon oneself to be the servant and student of all sentient beings and strives in whatever must be done. Thinking "the body is impermanent," one does not engage in any deception of the body, nor in treachery or pretense of any kind. Thinking "the body is impermanent," one does not place reliance on one's life, and even for the sake of life one does not commit evil. Thinking "the body is impermanent," one does not crave and cling to wealth and possessions, but relinquishes everything one owns. Noble son, in this way the bodhisattva, abiding in the aspect of impermanence and regarding the body as body, abundantly gains the benefit of excellent qualities.

What then is the aspect of permanence? When a bodhisattva abides regarding the body as body, and wisdom arises and emerges from the mental investigation of a mind endowed with virtue, he dedicates all of it entirely to omniscience — so that the lineage of the buddhas may be unbroken, the lineage of the Dharma may be unbroken, the lineage of the Saṅgha may be unbroken, and the entirety of the realm of sentient beings may be utterly protected. Whatever is given to all sentient beings is made common to all sentient beings — this is called the aspect of permanence.

That which is inexhaustible is called permanent, and the unconditioned is called inexhaustible. The unconditioned is permanent. Noble son, when a bodhisattva, in undertaking all roots of virtue, dedicates them entirely to the unconditioned nature of omniscience — this is called the aspect of permanence.

Emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness are called permanent. When a bodhisattva engages in the domain of emptiness, investigates signlessness with certainty, and undertakes all efforts in harmony with the causes of wishlessness — this is called the aspect of permanence.

Space is called permanent. When a bodhisattva, with a mind like space, free of conceptual thought, pursues the conduct of a bodhisattva — this is called the aspect of permanence.

Noble son, furthermore, when a bodhisattva cultivates the close establishment of mindfulness that regards the body as body, he assigns to his own body the bodies of all sentient beings, thinking: "I shall cause the bodies of all sentient beings to abide in the state of the buddha body." Just as the body of the Tathāgata is undefiled, so too does he contemplate the nature of reality of his own body in that same way. Skilled in the Dharma that is without defilement, he thoroughly recognizes the bodies of all sentient beings as having that same defining mark. With that undefiled body, he gathers roots of virtue whose very nature is undefiled.

With that undefiled mind, he dedicates all those roots of virtue to omniscience, which is itself undefiled. Having attained those undefiled qualities of Dharma, he does not arise from the defilements. What are those defilements? They are: the defilement of desire, the defilement of existence, the defilement of ignorance, and the defilement of views.

Possessed of thorough knowledge of the defilement of desire, yet for the sake of ripening sentient beings he is reborn in the desire realm (kāmadhātu) by deliberate intention. Possessed of thorough knowledge of the defilement of existence, yet for the sake of accumulating roots of virtue he takes hold of existence by deliberate intention. In order to uproot both the defilement of ignorance and the defilement of views from their very base, the bodhisattva enters into yogic practice.

As for his cultivation of the close establishment of mindfulness that regards the body as body: he discerns that the body has never arisen from a beginning in the past. He discerns that the body will not be transferred at the final end in

the future. He discerns that the body as it arises in the present moment is naturally empty of inherent existence. Dwelling thus in careful attention to the body in this way, he does not give rise to the view of the transitory collection (satkāyadṛṣṭi) that regards the body as a self. Free from the view of the transitory collection, he does not appropriate anything as "mine." Since there is no appropriation as "mine," he does not cling in the midst of whatever grasping arises. Without grasping, he fully attains non-contention. Having abandoned contention, there is no malice. Without malice, he fully attains patience. Having fully attained patience, he becomes neither inflated with arrogance nor prostrate with dejection. Being neither inflated nor dejected, he abides in the nature of reality. Abiding in the nature of reality, he no longer engages in what is contrary to the Dharma. Practicing the Dharma, he walks in the Dharma's own course. Walking in the Dharma's course, he finds truly excellent companions in the Dharma. Embraced by companions in the Dharma, he comes to hear the Dharma well. Possessed of hearing the Dharma, he no longer becomes defiled with respect to sense objects. Guarded with respect to objects, he accomplishes meditative absorption. Through meditative equipoise, he comes to know things exactly as they are. Knowing things exactly as they are, he no longer engages in conceptual thought nor in conceptual elaboration. Through non-conceptual elaboration, he does not waver. Through not wavering, he no longer acts and no longer constructs. When there is neither acting nor constructing, that is when, through the evenness of all phenomena, one attains phenomena exactly as they are, and then fully attains the wisdom of omniscience. This, son of good family, is the perfectly purified conduct of the bodhisattva's close establishment of mindfulness that regards the body as body.

Son of good family, what then is the perfectly purified conduct of the bodhisattva's close establishment of mindfulness that regards feelings as feelings? Son of good family, when the bodhisattva cultivates the close establishment of mindfulness that regards feelings as feelings, he will attain great compassion for sentient beings who abide in pleasurable feeling. He teaches: "That in which there is no feeling — that is true happiness." He cultivates the close establishment of mindfulness that regards feelings as feelings for the sake of causing all sentient beings to relinquish feeling. Even though he has donned the armor for the sake of bringing the feelings of sentient beings to cessation, he does not bring about the cessation of his own feelings. Whatever feelings he experiences, he encompasses and experiences

all of them entirely within great compassion. When he experiences a pleasant feeling, he attains great compassion for those sentient beings who indulge in desire, and he thoroughly abandons his own underlying tendency toward desire.

When he experiences a painful feeling, he attains great compassion for those sentient beings who indulge in aversion, and he thoroughly abandons his own underlying tendency toward aversion. When he experiences a feeling that is neither pleasant nor painful, he attains great compassion for those sentient beings who indulge in delusion, and he thoroughly abandons his own underlying tendency toward delusion.

He does not become attached to pleasant feeling, and he thoroughly crushes that attachment. He does not become angry at painful feeling, and he thoroughly crushes that anger. He does not become joined with ignorance in relation to the feeling that is neither painful nor pleasant, and he thoroughly crushes that ignorance.

Whatever feelings he experiences, he knows and experiences all of them as impermanent. He knows and experiences them as suffering. He knows and experiences them as selfless. He comes to know pleasant feeling as impermanent. He comes to know painful feeling as a thorn. He comes to know the feeling that is neither painful nor pleasant as stillness. Thus: whatever is pleasant is impermanent; whatever is painful is suffering itself; and whatever is neither pleasant nor painful is selfless.

Noble son, a bodhisattva who abides in this way, observing feelings as feelings, comes to know that all phenomena are without arising, without disintegration, without dissolution, and without abiding. He also individually discerns the arising and ceasing of all phenomena. As he so discerns them, wondering from where arising phenomena come and to where ceasing phenomena go, he does not correctly see the arising and ceasing of phenomena. Having come to know that phenomena come from nowhere and go nowhere, he works to bring all feelings to cessation. Yet having done so, he does not make a task of it. Why is that? Because he brings the feelings of all sentient beings to cessation, not merely his own feelings alone.

Noble son, this is the close establishment of mindfulness that regards feelings as feelings on the part of the bodhisattva, endowed with skillful means and fully held within great compassion. He understands perfectly well that feeling ceases, yet he does not actualize the cessation of feeling directly. Abiding in

the cultivation of the close establishment of mindfulness that regards feelings as feelings, he perfectly and correctly understands seclusion from feelings and thorough seclusion from them. In this there is nothing whatsoever that is experienced. In this there is nothing whatsoever that does the experiencing. All those phenomena are empty, devoid of self and what belongs to self, possessing no agent and no experiencer, dependent on causes and conditions, without an owner, without anything that is mine, without any appropriator. And yet in truth he does not perceive the very thing of those causes and conditions. Not perceiving it, he thinks: just as conditions are empty, so too are the phenomena arisen from conditions empty. Knowing this meaning of emptiness, he cultivates the close establishment of mindfulness that regards feelings as feelings through bodily seclusion, mental seclusion, knowing the meaning, knowing phenomena, and awareness of primordial wisdom. This is the thoroughly pure conduct of the bodhisattva's close establishment of mindfulness that regards feelings as feelings.

Noble son, in that regard, what is the thoroughly pure conduct of the bodhisattva's close establishment of mindfulness that regards mind as mind?

Noble son, in that regard, the bodhisattva who dwells in the close establishment of mindfulness that regards mind as mind establishes and thoroughly establishes that dwelling as the awakening mind, the close establishment of mindfulness. With the primordial wisdom of mindfulness of mind, he searches through mind entirely. And as he searches through mind entirely, he does not find mind correctly following after it within; he does not find mind correctly following after it without; he does not find mind correctly following after it within and without. In the aggregates he does not find mind correctly following after it. In the elements he does not find mind correctly following after it. In the sense sources he does not find mind correctly following after it.

Because he has not found mind by correctly following after it, he searches throughout the stream of mind, wondering from where mind arises, and he reflects thus: mind will arise from there being an object of reference. Then he reflects further: is that object of reference one thing and mind another, or is what the object of reference is itself the mind? If the object of reference were one thing and mind another, then mind would be twofold. But if what the object of reference is were itself the mind, then how could mind see that mind? It is not fitting for mind to see mind. Consider, for example: just as the very edge of a blade cannot cut that same edge, and the very tip of a finger

cannot touch that same tip, in just the same way mind itself cannot see that same mind.

Reflecting in this way, through proper application in this manner, he knows that the stream of mind, the tether of mind, the nature of reality of mind — that mind does not abide, is not annihilated, is not permanent, does not abide forever, is not without cause, does not conflict with conditions, arises neither from that nor from another, is neither that nor other — the fact that mind does not abide, that mind does not move, that mind does not appear, and that the intrinsic characteristic of mind, just as it is, does not disturb suchness: he knows it thus and sees it thus. Just as suchness is, so he thoroughly understands those minds to be seclusion itself. This seeing in just that way, noble son, is the thoroughly pure conduct of the bodhisattva's close establishment of mindfulness that regards mind as mind.

Noble son, furthermore, mind is not seen even in the slightest, is not seen in any aspect, is without conceptuality, is without discrimination, is without movement, is without conceit, and is without conceptual elaboration. This also is the bodhisattva's close establishment of mindfulness that regards mind as mind.

Noble son, furthermore, just as mind is without form, so too the roots of virtue that are deliberately cultivated by mind are without form. Just as the roots of virtue deliberately cultivated by mind are without form, so too the dedication of those to awakening mind is without form. Just as the dedication to awakening mind is without form, so too that awakening itself is without form. Therefore, just as mind is in its conduct, so it is with conduct; just as conduct is, so awakening is; and just as awakening is, so too the thorough dedication is — this is the meaning. The intrinsic nature of mind is awakening. The intrinsic nature of awakening is all phenomena. Whoever knows this thorough analysis of mind in this way — this is the bodhisattva's close establishment of mindfulness that regards mind as mind.

Noble son, furthermore, that which is swift, supremely swift, moving without abiding, resembling a monkey and like the wind, like the current of a stream and like the flame of a sesame-oil lamp, traveling to a great distance, without a body —

craving after objects, ranging over the six sense bases, mind that abides with the awareness of this and that — one-pointed, non-proliferating, utterly non-proliferating, one-pointed in calm abiding, undistracted: this is what is

called the abiding of mind.

In that regard, what is the perfect and complete close establishment of mindfulness? It is: knowing how to distinguish mind; knowing that mind abides in the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena; knowing that mind abides as mind; knowing that mind is luminous by its intrinsic nature; knowing mind just as it is; knowing mind thoroughly through the wisdom of direct perception; knowing mind as a phenomenon like an illusion; knowing mind as equal across the three times; knowing mind as suchness; and knowing mind as unmoving and without anything to be apprehended. This is called the perfect and complete close establishment of mindfulness.

One thoroughly understands that whatever is the intrinsic nature of one's own mind is also the intrinsic nature of the minds of all sentient beings, and having fully understood the intrinsic nature of mind, one teaches the Dharma accordingly. One thoroughly understands that whatever is the essential nature of one's own mind is also the essential nature of the minds of all sentient beings, and having understood the essential nature of mind, one teaches the Dharma accordingly. One thoroughly understands that whatever is the defining characteristic of one's own mind is also the defining characteristic of the conduct of the minds of all sentient beings, and having understood that defining characteristic of mind, one teaches the Dharma accordingly. Just as one's own mind is empty, one thoroughly understands that the minds of all sentient beings are likewise empty, and having understood those minds as emptiness, one teaches the Dharma accordingly. One thoroughly understands that whatever is the true gathering of one's own mind is also the true gathering of the minds of all sentient beings, and having understood that true gathering of mind, one teaches the Dharma accordingly. By the evenness of one's own mind, one thoroughly understands the evenness of the minds of all sentient beings. By the evenness of the minds of all sentient beings, one thoroughly understands that all phenomena are even. By the evenness of all phenomena, one thoroughly understands awakening as evenness, and mind does not make any alteration — it does not alter at all. Though one subsequently knows that the abiding of mind is the abiding of the dharmadhātu, one does not stir from that very nature of reality of mind's abiding. Noble son, this is the thoroughly pure conduct of the bodhisattva's close establishment of mindfulness that regards mind as mind.

Noble son, in that regard, what is the thoroughly pure conduct of the bodhisattva's close establishment of mindfulness that regards phenomena as

phenomena? Noble son, here a bodhisattva who abides in the close establishment of mindfulness that regards phenomena as phenomena thinks thus: only phenomena arise when they arise; only phenomena cease when they cease. In this there is no self, no sentient being, no life-force, no born one, no nourisher, no person, no individual, no one born from seed, no offspring of seed, no one who is born, no one who grows old, no one who dies, no one who transmigrates, no one who will be born. This is the nature of reality of phenomena: if something is cultivated, it comes about; if it is not cultivated, it does not come about. Whether it be wholesome, non-wholesome, or unmoved, in whatever way it was cultivated, in just that way it comes about — yet there is no one who does the cultivating of phenomena, and phenomena do not arise without cause and do not cease without cause. When one examines things closely in this way, there arises the wisdom of recollecting the Dharma regarding the three: the cultivation of meritorious, non-meritorious, and unmoved formations. Regarding these, one should apply oneself to the cultivation of merit. Through this, one will obtain the unsurpassed, supreme, and excellent qualities of a buddha —

and in particular it will become the cause of ten supremely exalted qualities. What are those ten? They are as follows.

Through the complete purification of body, one obtains the major marks, the minor marks of excellence, and the *uṣṇīṣa* on the crown of the head that cannot be seen even by looking, and one utterly transcends all harm from others.

Through the complete purification of speech, the Tathāgata's voice, in its sixty aspects, is brought to complete perfection, satisfying every sentient being.

Through the complete purification of mind, one bears no anger toward any sentient being, and one's meditative absorption remains unshaken in an unbroken, continuous stream.

Through the complete purification of the individual discriminating knowledges (Skt. *pratisaṃvid*), one obtains inexhaustible knowledge of meaning, of Dharma, of definitive expression, and of eloquence.

Through the complete purification of great loving-kindness, one establishes all sentient beings on the path to *nirvāṇa*.

Through the complete purification of great compassion, one never grows weary of wandering in *saṃsāra* for measureless eons.

Through the complete perfection of the ten powers, one knows the superior and inferior faculties of every sentient being.

Through the complete perfection of fearlessness, one fully understands what constitutes an obstacle and what does not.

Through the complete perfection of the unshared qualities of a buddha, one beholds a wisdom that is unattached to the past, the future, and the present, the three times.

Through the complete perfection of all buddha qualities, one fully realizes self-arisen wisdom.

These are the ten qualities — the unsurpassed, supreme, excellent, ultimate, and distinctly exalted buddha qualities — whose cause one thereby becomes. Seeing this significance and this power, one becomes insatiable in accumulating the collection of merit.

And in order not to bring forth non-meritorious formations, one strives, thinking: "How may I ensure that all unwholesome phenomena leave not even a habitual tendency in me, in any respect whatsoever?"

And although one cultivates the unmoved formations, understanding unmoved formations fully, and thereby arouses entry into the unmoved absorption, one does not take that meditative absorption as the essence, and one does not take rebirth through the power of that absorption. Rather, in order to accumulate the collection of merit and to bring sentient beings to full maturation, one is reborn even in the desire realm through the power of aspiration.

Noble son, thus it is that a bodhisattva of skillful means, dwelling in the close placement of mindfulness that observes phenomena according to the Dharma, cultivates those qualities that lead to awakening and abandons those qualities that are contrary to awakening — yet by bringing forth virtuous qualities, one does not fall into the view of permanence; and by abandoning non-virtuous qualities, one does not fall into the view of annihilation. That which is free of annihilation and free of permanence is the bodhisattva's Middle Way path, which has completely abandoned the extremes of permanence and annihilation.

And what exactly is that? Improper mental attention and ignorance — both of these are extremes. The Middle Way between those two is neither imputed nor capable of being imputed. This is what is called the Middle Way path of

phenomena.

Likewise: ignorance and the absence of ignorance; formations and the absence of formations; consciousness and the absence of consciousness; name-and-form and the absence of name-and-form; the six sense sources and the absence of the six sense sources; contact and the absence of contact; feeling and the absence of feeling; craving and the absence of craving; grasping and the absence of grasping; existence and the absence of existence; birth and the absence of birth; aging-and-death and the absence of aging-and-death; grief, lamentation, pain, mental distress, and despair — each of these pairs is also a pair of extremes. The Middle Way between any such pair is neither imputed nor capable of being imputed. This is what is called the Middle Way path of phenomena.

Such, then, is the Middle Way path of phenomena.

It cannot be shown to be like that. The Middle Way is without imputation, incapable of being imputed, without signs, without location, without apprehension, without basis, peaceful, utterly peaceful, and thoroughly at peace.

Noble son, consider this example: the point from which an arrow is shot and the point at which it strikes — both of these are extremes. The middle between the shooting and the striking cannot be imputed and is incapable of being imputed; it cannot be seen or touched. In the same way, noble son, the object through which consciousness arises and the place where individual awareness resides — both of these are extremes. The middle between those two cannot be demonstrated. This, noble son, is called the Middle Way only as a conventional designation; ultimately, it is not so. The ultimate itself is inexpressible. In it there is neither the lesser nor the greater. That in which there is neither the lesser nor the greater is the Middle Way.

Noble son, furthermore, self and selflessness — both of these are extremes. The thoroughly pure essential nature of self and selflessness is the Middle Way. Life-force and person — both of these are extremes. The thoroughly pure essential nature of life-force and person is the Middle Way. Signs and signlessness — both of these are extremes. Non-conceptuality with respect to signlessness is the Middle Way. Reference object and absence of reference object — both of these are extremes. The absence of arising and ceasing in conceptual thought is the Middle Way. The false and the true — both of these are extremes. The inexpressible is the Middle Way. This shore and the far

shore — both of these are extremes. The dissolution of the collection of personality views (satkāyadṛṣṭi) is the Middle Way. The conditioned and the unconditioned — both of these are extremes. The absence of engagement is the Middle Way. Saṃsāra and nirvāṇa — both of these are extremes. The absence of individual cognition is the Middle Way.

Noble son, when a bodhisattva abides in the close placement of mindfulness, contemplating phenomena in accordance with phenomena in this way, he abides in mindfulness because the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, is indivisible. He fully understands that all phenomena are gathered into the dharmadhātu. Whatever the dharmadhātu is, that itself is the realm of sentient beings. Because the dharmadhātu is indivisible, he penetrates the fact that the realm of sentient beings is indivisible. He fully understands that both the dharmadhātu and the realm of sentient beings are equal to the expanse of space. Having known all phenomena as a single expanse, he abides contemplating phenomena in accordance with phenomena, yet he does not become attached to or fixated upon phenomena. Whenever he sees, he does not differentiate phenomena as separate. Although he sees phenomena, it is not seeing with the fleshly eye, not seeing with the divine eye, and not seeing with the eye of wisdom. Why? Because his eye does not perceive signs — therefore he does not see with the fleshly eye. His eye does not fall into deliberate fabrication — therefore he does not see with the divine eye. His eye does not move about among conceptual elaborations — therefore he does not see with the eye of wisdom. One who abides contemplating phenomena in accordance with phenomena sees all phenomena exactly as they are and does not abide in any phenomenon whatsoever. Knowing all phenomena to be without abiding, and yet through that recollection of phenomena not abandoning former aspirations — this, noble son, is what the buddhas have permitted as the bodhisattva's close placement of mindfulness that contemplates phenomena in accordance with phenomena.

And even while examining any profound phenomenon individually, never relinquishing the recollection of the awakening mind of omniscience — this, noble son, is the pure conduct of the bodhisattva's close placement of mindfulness in the practice of contemplating phenomena in accordance with phenomena.

Abiding in those four close placements of mindfulness thoroughly abandons the four inversions. What are the four? By contemplating the body and

remaining with the body in accordance with the body, one thoroughly abandons the inversion of perceiving the unpleasant as pleasant. By contemplating feelings and remaining with feelings in accordance with feelings, one thoroughly abandons the inversion of perceiving the suffering as pleasant. By contemplating the mind and remaining with the mind in accordance with the mind, one thoroughly abandons the inversion of perceiving the impermanent as permanent. By contemplating phenomena and remaining with phenomena in accordance with phenomena, one thoroughly abandons the inversion of perceiving the selfless as a self. Through the absence of these inversions, one accomplishes what is authentic. Having entered into what is authentic, all the conduct of the bodhisattva becomes utterly pure.

Noble son, in this way, the perfect purity of the bodhisattva's conduct fully attains the perfect purity of the conduct of the four genuine abandonments (Skt. *samyakprahāṇa*). And what is the perfect purity of the conduct of the four genuine abandonments? It is this: the bodhisattva's mind flows naturally and effortlessly toward wholesome phenomena, but not toward unwholesome ones. Therefore, effort is applied to abandon those sinful and unwholesome phenomena that have already arisen; effort is applied to prevent those sinful and unwholesome phenomena that have not yet arisen from arising; effort is applied to generate those wholesome phenomena that have not yet arisen; and effort is applied so that those wholesome phenomena that have already arisen may remain, not decline, increase, and be brought to complete perfection.

Noble son, because that bodhisattva's former karma is perfectly pure, wholesome phenomena naturally become manifest of their own accord. Without effort, spontaneously and effortlessly, wholesome phenomena that have not yet arisen do arise. And wholesome phenomena that have already arisen do not decline.

Noble son, in this way, that perfect purity of the bodhisattva's conduct is governed by the mind with respect to these four genuine abandonments — it is not governed by effort. It is a pure, unstained, and blameless mind, accompanied by the great loving-kindness and great compassion that all buddhas have permitted, and the mental factors born of such a mind, that enter into it. That entering into what is authentic is called abiding in the genuine abandonments. Why? Because the abandonment here is equanimous — it is not unequanimous. The engagement here is equanimous — it is not

unequanimous. What is called genuine abandonment is engaging equanimously by means of equanimity, and accomplishing equanimously by means of equanimity. This is why it is called genuine abandonment.

In one who has thus genuinely entered, the four bases of miraculous power (Skt. ṛddhipāda) will be cultivated to complete perfection. What are the four? The basis of miraculous power consisting of the meditative absorption of aspiration endowed with formations of abandonment; the basis of miraculous power consisting of the meditative absorption of diligence endowed with formations of abandonment; the basis of miraculous power consisting of the meditative absorption of mind endowed with formations of abandonment; and the basis of miraculous power consisting of the meditative absorption of investigation endowed with formations of abandonment.

Through the superior intention of the awakening mind, aspiration will become light. Through the abandonment of unwholesome phenomena, diligence will become light. Through the full attainment of great compassion, the mind will become light. Through the full attainment of skillful means, investigation will become light.

Noble son, the bodhisattva who has fully accomplished the aspects of awakening through these four bases of miraculous power fully attains four masteries. What are the four? They are as follows.

The first is the attainment of mastery over life. Through mastery over life, when he wishes, he takes up a long life among sentient beings whose lives are short, bringing those beings to full maturity; and, for the purpose of bringing to full contentment those beings whose long lives would make them weary when the Dharma is taught, he takes up a short life. In every birth, whether as a god or a human, he exercises sovereignty over the measure of life. Noble son, this is the first mastery that the bodhisattva attains.

Noble son, furthermore, the bodhisattva attains mastery over the body. Through mastery over the body, having fully obtained the mind-made body, whatever form of body, whatever physical appearance, complexion, major marks, shape, and mode of conduct will bring sentient beings to full maturity and bring them to be tamed — in just that way the bodhisattva manifests a body, form, complexion, major marks, shape, and mode of conduct. When he wishes, the bodies, forms, complexions, major marks, shapes, and modes of conduct of all sentient beings come to resemble his. Noble son, this is the second mastery that the bodhisattva attains.

Noble son, furthermore, the bodhisattva attains mastery over Dharma. Through mastery over Dharma, he comes to rely upon Dharma that transcends the world and does not rely upon the dharmas of the world. Yet even while relying upon Dharma that transcends the world, he appears in all worldly activities without ever moving from that transcendent gnosis. This gnosis is characterized by wisdom and primordial wisdom free of attachment, by being the very nature of the profound gnosis of dependent origination, and by establishing the Dharma through which he gladdens the world together with its gods. He gives discourses on Dharma of such a kind that, by it, immeasurable sentient beings are tamed exactly in accordance with their thoughts and aspirations. Noble son, this is the third mastery that the bodhisattva attains.

Noble son, furthermore, the bodhisattva attains mastery over blessing. Through mastery over blessing, he consecrates all the vast oceans of world-systems of a great trichiliocosm into a single ocean, and yet there is no merging, and he manifests that activity everywhere. He consecrates all the king of mountains, Mount Meru, of the world-systems of a great trichiliocosm into a single mountain, and yet the sons of the gods of the Four Great Kings and the sons of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three do not know they have been brought together, and he manifests that activity everywhere. He consecrates these world-systems of a great trichiliocosm so that they become a ground of precious jewels, or a ground of sandalwood, or a ground of incense, or a ground of flowers, or they become transformed into space, or become entirely filled with water, or entirely filled with fire, or become entirely filled with all manner of precious jewels — when he consecrates them in this way, they come to abide in just that state. Likewise, with every form of blessing, whatever he consecrates becomes as he has consecrated it, and the moment his mind generates the intent, all those blessings abide throughout in just that way. Noble son, this is the fourth mastery that the bodhisattva attains.

Noble son, furthermore, a bodhisattva who abides in the four bases of miraculous power dwells, sits, and converses together with all the Blessed Ones, the buddhas of the ten directions. Likewise with all the Brahmās, all the Śakras (Indra), all the world-protectors, and with gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (scent-eaters), asuras,

garuḍas, kinnaras (half-human celestials), great serpents, and all humans and non-humans alike — with all of these he dwells, sits, and converses together.

And why is that? It is because that bodhisattva has thoroughly perfected those bases of miraculous power.

Now, what is the thorough perfecting of the bases of miraculous power? It is as follows.

In order to make the body light, one rises in the presence of one's teachers and worthy recipients of generosity, attends upon them, speaks respectfully, pays homage, joins the palms, and acts in accordance and harmony with them. In order to make speech light, one receives instructions gladly and harmoniously, and acts in keeping with whatever has been said. In order to make the mind light, one is without pride and without quarrelsomeness; one attends upon one's teachers with reverence, bowing and prostrating deeply; the mind becomes workable; one is free of mental torment; one does not abandon diligence in renunciation; one fulfils the vows of truth to completion; one exerts oneself without slackening; one accomplishes what needs to be done; one does not act with laziness; the mind does not shrink back; one dispels attachment and desire; one pacifies aversion; one clears away the darkness of delusion; one is without craving; one is without envy; one is free of miserliness; one applies oneself to aspiration and higher aspiration; one accomplishes and bears the aims of others; one relieves those who are burdened and weak; one lays stepping-stones across muddy ground; one provides bridges to cross rivers; one equips ferries for crossing waterways; one fulfils the aspirations of sentient beings; one causes them to hear words of joy; one does not speak of others' faults; one heals the faults that have arisen; one dispels regrets; one clears away all occasions for agitation; one thoroughly understands from which element something arises; one gives away entirely all possessions that are dear; having given, one has no regret; for the sake of all sentient beings, one dedicates to awakening; one proceeds led by faith; one leads others to take up roots of virtue correctly; one does not cling to one's own happiness; one bestows happiness on others; one is content with one's own gain; one has no envy toward others' gain; one inclines toward renunciation; one leads others to delight in renunciation as well; one is grateful for what has been done and acknowledges it; one's friendship is steadfast; one's mind is even toward both friends and enemies; one gives horses, elephants, chariots, and small gifts to servants; one properly encourages those who are weary; one gives fearlessness to all sentient beings; one regards those who are trained merely as a teacher would; one does not despise the untrained; one shares one's wealth with the poor; one serves

those who are ill; one gives medicine; one does not revile those who have acted well; one pays homage to the Three Jewels; toward those who show reverence and those who do not, one abides in equanimity; one utterly transcends the concerns of the world; one refrains entirely from all evil; one is unstained by all worldly concerns; one accomplishes all good qualities; the awakening mind goes before everything; and mindfulness does not diminish.

Noble son, this is the thorough perfecting of the bodhisattva's bases of miraculous power.

When the bases of miraculous power have been thoroughly perfected in this way, there will be no decline all the way up to the heart of awakening — no decline whatsoever. Noble son, this is the utterly pure conduct of the bodhisattva with respect to the bases of miraculous power.

Noble son, what is the utterly pure conduct of the bodhisattva with respect to the faculties? It is as follows. The faculty of faith (śraddhā) is that which is unshakeable. The faculty of diligence is that which does not lean upon others. The faculty of mindfulness is that which does not forget the awakening mind. The faculty of meditative absorption is that which does not abandon great compassion. The faculty of wisdom is that which strives to fully embrace all phenomena.

Noble son, furthermore, aspiring with faith and devotion toward all buddha qualities — this is the bodhisattva's faculty of faith. Being utterly free from weariness in authentically accomplishing all buddha qualities — this is the faculty of diligence. Not forgetting all buddha qualities — this is the faculty of mindfulness. Accomplishing through direct realization all the meditative absorptions of the buddhas — this is the faculty of meditative absorption. Dedicating oneself entirely to the purpose of cutting through the doubts of all sentient beings — this is the faculty of wisdom.

Noble son, furthermore, becoming undivided in resolve toward the awakening of all buddhas — this is the bodhisattva's faculty of faith. Having an intention of supreme excellence that goes beyond the ordinary — this is the faculty of diligence. Being skilled in dedication — this is the faculty of mindfulness. Sending forth rays of light equally to all sentient beings — this is the faculty of meditative absorption. Thoroughly knowing the faculties of all sentient beings — this is the faculty of wisdom.

Noble son, furthermore, causing all sentient beings to pass utterly beyond attachment — this is the bodhisattva's faculty of faith. Causing all sentient

beings to be completely liberated from attachment — this is the faculty of diligence. Being unattached to anything whatsoever — this is the faculty of mindfulness. Thoroughly realizing within oneself the very equanimity of attachment in all sentient beings — this is the faculty of meditative absorption. Knowing everything that is attachment and non-attachment — this is the faculty of wisdom.

Noble son, furthermore, that which becomes free from turbidity — this is the faculty of faith. That which parts from whatever causes turbidity of mind — this is the faculty of diligence. That which does not abandon mindfulness of the nature of reality free from turbidity — this is the faculty of mindfulness. That which knows how to enter into and arise from meditative absorption and meditative equipoise with a mind free from turbidity — this is the faculty of meditative absorption. That which, through having attained the qualities of non-turbidity, establishes those who have become turbid in the nature of reality that is free from turbidity — this is the faculty of wisdom.

Noble son, furthermore, abandoning all non-virtuous qualities — this is the bodhisattva's faculty of faith. Authentically accomplishing all virtuous qualities — this is the faculty of diligence. Not forgetting those virtuous qualities that have been accomplished and those that have not yet been accomplished — this is the faculty of mindfulness. Not desiring the joy and bliss of meditative absorption, and practicing meditation for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings — this is the faculty of meditative absorption. Knowing for oneself, in their very equanimity, the virtuous and non-virtuous qualities individually — this is the faculty of wisdom.

Noble son, furthermore, the bodhisattva through faith abandons; through diligence authentically accomplishes; through mindfulness does not waste; through meditative absorption guards; and through wisdom discriminates.

Noble son, furthermore, the bodhisattva through faith thoroughly relinquishes grasping at self; through diligence abandons grasping at what is mine; through mindfulness passes utterly beyond the view of the transitory collection; through meditative absorption abandons the sixty-two wrong views; and through wisdom completely relinquishes those afflictions that have become bound together with habitual tendencies.

Noble son, this is the completely pure conduct of the faculties of a bodhisattva.

Noble son, what then is the completely pure conduct of the powers of a bodhisattva? It is this: by relying upon those very faculties, one becomes

unconquerable by all māras; one is not seized away by the two vehicles of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas; one becomes irreversible from this Great Vehicle; one is not subdued by any affliction; one becomes steadfast in one's former vows; one becomes supremely stable in mind; one becomes endowed with physical strength; the faculties become sharpened; enemies cannot prevail; and one is not shaken by any opposing argument whatsoever.

Noble son, thus it is that through the bodhisattva's power of faith one does not perform what ought not to be done. Through the power of diligence one performs what ought to be done. Through the power of mindfulness one does not waste the deeds one has accomplished. Through the power of meditative absorption one is not wounded by forms, sounds, smells, tastes, and tactile objects. Through the power of wisdom one passes utterly beyond all remorse and all agitation.

Noble son, furthermore, through the bodhisattva's power of faith one does not go over to faith in anything else. Through the power of diligence one does not become faint and give up halfway. Through the power of mindfulness one thoroughly attains dhāraṇī and eloquence. Through the power of meditative absorption one teaches the Dharma with evenness. Through the power of wisdom one cuts through all the doubts of all sentient beings.

Noble son, furthermore, through the bodhisattva's power of faith one brings the power of aspiration to complete perfection. Through the power of diligence one brings the power of liberation to complete perfection. Through the power of mindfulness one brings the power of the wisdom that sees liberation to complete perfection. Through the power of meditative absorption one brings the power of mind and intention to complete perfection. Through the power of wisdom one fully satisfies the conduct of all sentient beings.

Noble son, furthermore, through the bodhisattva's power of faith one thoroughly abandons the stain of miserliness. Through the power of diligence one fully gives away all one's possessions. Through the power of mindfulness one dedicates entirely to awakening. Through the power of meditative absorption one gives with an equanimous mind. Through the power of wisdom one has no expectation of karmic maturation.

Noble son, furthermore, through the bodhisattva's power of faith one thoroughly abandons the stain of corrupt ethical discipline. Through the power of diligence one does not transgress the trainings. Through the power of mindfulness one dedicates entirely to awakening. Through the power of

meditative absorption one progresses to the ground of taming, peace, and wisdom. Through the power of wisdom one thoroughly abandons ethical discipline that is motivated by deliberate striving.

Noble son, furthermore, through the bodhisattva's power of faith one thoroughly abandons the stain of malice. Through the power of diligence one cultivates patience. Through the power of mindfulness one dedicates entirely to awakening. Through the power of meditative absorption one protects and watches over sentient beings. Through the power of wisdom one does not conceptualize self, sentient beings, or patience.

Noble son, furthermore, through the bodhisattva's power of faith one thoroughly abandons the stain of laziness.

Through the power of diligence one causes every undertaking to come to full completion. Through the power of mindfulness one dedicates entirely to awakening. Through the power of meditative absorption one accomplishes the thorough pliancy of body and mind. Through the power of wisdom one neither acts nor conceptually elaborates.

Noble son, furthermore, through the bodhisattva's power of faith one thoroughly abandons the stain of distraction. Through the power of diligence one perfectly accomplishes the factors of meditative concentration. Through the power of mindfulness one dedicates entirely to one-pointedness. Through the power of meditative absorption one does not waver from meditative absorption. Through the power of wisdom one thoroughly abandons attachment to that meditative absorption.

Noble son, furthermore, through the bodhisattva's power of faith one thoroughly abandons the stain of degenerate wisdom. Through the power of diligence one fully seeks out learning. Through the power of mindfulness one applies oneself in accordance with what is proper. Through the power of meditative absorption one perfectly attains certainty of mind. Through the power of wisdom one thoroughly accomplishes it with diligent effort.

Noble son, furthermore, through the bodhisattva's power of faith one perfectly attains the seven noble treasures. Through the power of diligence one perfectly attains the seven factors of awakening. Through the power of mindfulness one perfectly attains the six recollections. Through the power of meditative absorption one completely transcends the seven stations of consciousness. Through the power of wisdom one completely transcends the eight grounds of wrong determination.

Noble son, furthermore, that which is unwavering, with mind and intention free from turbidity — this is the perfectly pure conduct of the power of faith of a bodhisattva. That which does not turn back, with nothing to take up and nothing to discard — this is the perfectly pure conduct of the power of diligence. That which is preceded by mindfulness yet is free from mindfulness and mental engagement — this is the perfectly pure conduct of the power of mindfulness. That in which, through the thorough taming of mind, one naturally knows how to enter into and arise from meditative absorption and meditative equipoise — this is the perfectly pure conduct of the power of meditative absorption. That which is skilled in dispelling all views — this is the perfectly pure conduct of the power of wisdom.

Noble son, furthermore, the characteristic of bringing serenity is the perfectly pure conduct of the power of faith of a bodhisattva. The characteristic of irreversibility is the perfectly pure conduct of the power of diligence. The characteristic of non-forgetfulness is the perfectly pure conduct of the power of mindfulness. The characteristic of non-distraction is the perfectly pure conduct of the power of meditative absorption. The characteristic of discernment is the perfectly pure conduct of the power of wisdom. Noble son, this is the perfectly pure conduct of the powers of a bodhisattva.

Noble son, what then is the perfectly pure conduct of the bodhisattva in the factors of awakening? Noble son, the factors of awakening of a bodhisattva are seven in number. What are these seven? They are as follows: the factor of awakening that is right mindfulness, the factor of awakening that is right discernment of phenomena, the factor of awakening that is right diligence, the factor of awakening that is right joy, the factor of awakening that is right pliancy, the factor of awakening that is right meditative absorption, and the factor of awakening that is right equanimity.

Among these, the factor of awakening that is right mindfulness is that which, having accumulated the qualities pertaining to awakening, does not allow those accumulated qualities to be dissipated. This is the factor of awakening that is right mindfulness.

The factor of awakening that is right discernment of phenomena is that which becomes yoked together with the accumulation of insight. This is the factor of awakening that is right discernment of phenomena.

The factor of awakening that is right diligence is that which causes abandonment to become exceptional. This is the factor of awakening that is

right diligence.

The factor of awakening that is right joy is that which dispels discontentment. This is the factor of awakening that is right joy.

The factor of awakening that is right pliancy is that which thoroughly purifies body and mind. This is the factor of awakening that is right pliancy.

The factor of awakening that is right meditative absorption is that which makes liberation its very essence. This is the factor of awakening that is right meditative absorption.

The factor of awakening that is right equanimity is that which makes whatever has been done into something accomplished. This is what is called the factor of awakening that is right equanimity.

Furthermore, son of good family, that which does not forget the intention toward awakening is the factor of awakening that is right mindfulness. That which strives to fully uphold the noble Dharma is the factor of awakening that is right discernment of phenomena. That which, through ripening sentient beings, does not grow weary is the factor of awakening that is right diligence. That which abides in delight at the joy of the noble Dharma is the factor of awakening that is right joy. That which establishes sentient beings in pliancy is the factor of awakening that is right pliancy. That which establishes sentient beings in meditative absorption is the factor of awakening that is right meditative absorption. That which establishes sentient beings in equanimity through direct knowledge is the factor of awakening that is right equanimity.

Furthermore, son of good family, that which holds no recollection of, and pays no attention to, the vehicles of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas is the fully pure conduct of the factor of awakening that is right mindfulness. That which is skilled in the wisdom of fully distinguishing the words of all phenomena is the fully pure conduct of the factor of awakening that is right discernment of phenomena. That which renders the activities of body, speech, and mind supple is the fully pure conduct of the factor of awakening that is right diligence. That which abandons attachment and anger is the fully pure conduct of the factor of awakening that is right joy. That which has accomplished what was to be done and fulfilled what was to be carried out is the fully pure conduct of the factor of awakening that is right pliancy. That which, while engaging in all worldly activities, is nonetheless able to enter into one-pointed meditative equipoise is the fully pure conduct of the factor of awakening that is right meditative absorption. That which, while abiding firmly

in the non-dual Dharma, is without conceptual affirmation or negation, yet in equanimity appears everywhere and likewise regards sentient beings with that same view — this is the fully pure conduct of the factor of awakening that is right equanimity.

Furthermore, son of good family, a bodhisattva who thoroughly comprehends all phenomena, who correctly realizes them, who fully knows them, who measures them, who penetrates their nearness in conceptual examination, and who understands all the higher and lower conduct of sentient beings — and who, while abiding in that understanding, also cultivates the path leading to states of woe, along with the latent tendencies toward existence and non-existence, and is free from all entanglement — these, son of good family, are called the factors of awakening of a bodhisattva. This is the domain of practice of the noble ones and not of those who are not noble.

That which is the domain of practice of the noble ones is not the domain of practice of the evil māras. That which is the domain of practice of the noble ones is not the domain of practice of any of those possessed of pride. That which is the domain of practice of the noble ones is not the domain of practice of any who oppose through debate. That which is the domain of practice of the noble ones is not the domain of practice of any who fix their attention on signs. That which is the domain of practice of the noble ones is not the domain of practice of form, sound, smell, taste, touch, or any phenomena whatsoever. That which is the domain of practice of the noble ones is not the domain of practice of any who cling to feelings. That which is the domain of practice of the noble ones is not the domain of practice of mind, mentation, or consciousness. That which is the domain of practice of the noble ones is not the domain of practice of what is seen, heard, distinguished, or cognized. And that which is the domain of practice of the noble ones is not even the domain of practice of those who attend mentally to the perception of nirvāṇa. That which is not the domain of practice of any phenomenon whatsoever — that is the domain of practice of the noble ones. That which is not the domain of practice of thought, conceptual thought, or thorough conceptualization with respect to any phenomenon — that is the domain of practice of the noble ones. That in which no phenomenon whatsoever arises at all — that is the domain of practice of the noble ones. That which is incompatible with all phenomena — that is the domain of practice of the noble ones. That in which there is no dispute regarding any phenomenon — that is the domain of practice of the noble ones. That in which all phenomena are without signs —

that is the domain of practice of the noble ones.

Son of good family, this completely pure domain of practice of the noble ones is the completely pure conduct of the factors of awakening of a bodhisattva.

Son of good family, what then is the completely pure conduct of the path of a bodhisattva? It is this: right view, right thought, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, and right meditative absorption.

Now as for what was said — right view — what is right view? The view that all phenomena are equal is called right view. It does not give rise to the view of a self, the view of a sentient being, the view of a life-force, the view of a person, or the view of emptiness. Why is that? The view of a self, the view of a sentient being, the view of a life-force, the view of a person, and the view of emptiness are all the same. Nor does it give rise to the view of annihilation, the view of permanence, or the view of emptiness. Why is that? The view of annihilation, the view of permanence, and the view of emptiness are all the same. Nor does it give rise to the view of arising, the view of cessation, or the view of emptiness. Why is that? The view of arising, the view of cessation, and the view of emptiness are all the same. Nor does it give rise to the view of the transitory collection, the view of grasping at I, the view of grasping at mine, or the view of emptiness. Why is that? The view of the transitory collection, the view of grasping at I, the view of grasping at mine, and the view of emptiness are all the same. Nor does it give rise to viewing a buddha, viewing the Dharma, viewing the Saṅgha, or the view of emptiness. Why is that? Viewing a buddha, viewing the Dharma, viewing the Saṅgha, and the view of emptiness are all the same.

Noble son, however slight the object of a view may be, even a view whose object is nirvāṇa is still not a right view. That which is free from all views — inferior, superior, and middling — is called the right view. Why is that? Because that which views things as equal is not one that views them as unequal.

And how does one view things as equal without viewing them as unequal? If one thinks, "The phenomena of ordinary persons are inferior, and the phenomena of those in training are superior," that is viewing things as unequal. If one thinks, "The phenomena of ordinary persons are defiled, and the phenomena of those beyond training are undefiled," that is viewing things as unequal. If one thinks, "The phenomena of ordinary persons are accompanied by acquisitiveness, and the phenomena of pratyekabuddhas are

free of acquisitiveness," that is viewing things as unequal. If one thinks, "The phenomena of ordinary persons are afflicted, and the phenomena of bodhisattvas are free of affliction," that is viewing things as unequal. If one thinks, "The phenomena of ordinary persons are conditioned, and the phenomena of buddhas are unconditioned," that is viewing things as unequal.

When one perceives all phenomena as having, by the very intrinsic nature of the phenomena of ordinary persons, the same essential nature as the intrinsic nature of the phenomena of those in training — that is called the right view. When one perceives the emptiness of the phenomena of ordinary persons and the emptiness of the phenomena of those beyond training as equal — that is called the right view. When one perceives as equal the realization of the equality of conditions among the phenomena of ordinary persons and the realization of the equality of conditions among the phenomena of pratyekabuddhas — that is called the right view. When one perceives the seclusion of the phenomena of ordinary persons and the seclusion of the phenomena of bodhisattvas as equal — that is called the right view. When one perceives as equal the equality of non-establishment among the phenomena of ordinary persons and the equality of non-establishment among the phenomena of buddhas — that is called the right view.

Whoever sees things as equal does not engage the mind in duality. Whoever sees them as non-dual sees truly. Whoever sees things as equal makes no distinction among them. Whoever sees them as without distinction sees truly. Whoever sees things as equal does not give rise to conceptual thought regarding inferior, middling, or superior phenomena. Whoever sees all phenomena as free of conceptual thought sees truly. Whoever sees things as equal sees nothing whatsoever, and seeing nothing whatsoever is seeing truly. Whoever sees things as equal has no phenomenon appear to them at all. Whoever sees all phenomena as without appearance sees truly.

Noble son, whoever sees these phenomena in this way sees truly. This — seeing just as things are, and seeing them in equality — is called the right view within the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya.

When this teaching on the right view was expounded, five hundred monks were liberated in mind from the defilements without clinging. Many thousands of bodhisattvas gave rise to patient acceptance of the dharmatā of equality.

Noble son, what then is the right deliberation of a bodhisattva? It is whatever deliberation leads to the abandonment of deliberation. And what is that? It is

this: being skilled in insight that is thoroughly embraced by calm abiding, one considers which phenomenon is endowed with which phenomenon and examines those phenomena accordingly. One deliberates. Then one understands that all phenomena are mutually non-endowed, not fully endowed, and unmixed.

Having understood it in that way, if one does not even deliberate in an equanimous manner, there is no question of deliberating in a non-equanimous manner — that simply has no basis. One abandons deliberation about phenomena, thorough deliberation, and all forms of conceptual thought, and one no longer deliberates at all. This non-conceptual thought is called right deliberation.

Noble son, what then is a bodhisattva's right speech? It is whatever words cause distress neither to oneself nor to others, that bring about the affliction of neither oneself nor others, and that harm neither oneself nor others. That is called right speech.

Furthermore, right speech is whatever words lead one to determine that all phenomena are equal in nature. And the words that arise from this determination of the Dharma, as words that settle the Dharma, are called right speech.

Furthermore, right speech is speech that is equal toward those who are dear and those who are not dear, speech that is equal in declaring that all phenomena are empty, that all phenomena are signless, wishless, without construction, unborn, and unarisen, speech that is equal in declaring that all formations are impermanent, all formations are suffering, all phenomena are without self, and nirvāṇa is peace, and speech that is equal in declaring that all phenomena are without self, without sentient being, without life, without person, and devoid of any self, that all phenomena arise through dependent origination and have no essential nature, and that just as the cause is, so too is the result. That is right speech.

Furthermore, what is called right speech is that which leads other sentient beings and other persons into the true Dharma and engages them in the perfect taking-hold of awakening. That is called right speech.

What then is the thorough purity of right speech? It is all speech that issues from being fully embraced by a buddha. Noble son, this is called the thorough purity of a bodhisattva's right speech.

Noble son, what then is a bodhisattva's right action at its limit? It is action through which karma is exhausted, not action undertaken in order to accumulate more karma. It is action through which afflictions are calmed and pacified, not action undertaken in order to inflame the afflictions. It is action through which one becomes free from the afflictions, not action undertaken in order to generate afflictions. That is called right action at its limit.

Noble son, furthermore, a bodhisattva's right action at its limit is this: one thoroughly understands these phenomena in this way, and while one engages in all the wholesome acts of construction, those very acts of construction appear as hollow, as accumulated husks, as without essence, and as empty. Noble son, this is called a bodhisattva's right action at its limit, accomplished through the aspects of awakening.

Noble son, what then is a bodhisattva's right livelihood? It is whatever livelihood causes no harm to oneself, no harm to others, and no harm to both. That is called right livelihood.

Furthermore, right livelihood is whatever livelihood does not accumulate any afflictions whatsoever. That is called right livelihood.

And as for what is called a bodhisattva's right livelihood: it is that through which the livelihood of all sentient beings becomes thoroughly pure. With regard to that thoroughly pure livelihood, one neither submits to it excessively nor fails to engage with it, and it is a livelihood through which both one's own purpose and the purpose of others —

are completely fulfilled in their Dharmic purpose — this, O son of good family, is a bodhisattva's right livelihood.

O son of good family, what then is a bodhisattva's right effort? It is the wholehearted taking hold of the mind, the aspiration, the striving, the enthusiasm, the undertaking, the unflagging perseverance, and the making manifest through genuine diligence — all for the sake of genuinely accomplishing those virtuous and profound Dharma teachings. This is called right effort.

Furthermore, right effort is effort that is balanced, not unbalanced. How is it balanced and not unbalanced? It is that one neither equalizes phenomena nor differentiates them, that one acts not and proliferates not. One strives in accordance with the nature of reality of those phenomena exactly as it is, and with the way those phenomena abide exactly as they are. One strives in

accordance with the true nature of reality of those phenomena exactly as it is. One strives in accordance with the sameness of those phenomena and their being without distinction, exactly as it is. Moreover, that right effort is wholly dedicated to omniscience for the sake of abandoning the wrong effort of all sentient beings. O son of good family, this is a bodhisattva's right effort.

O son of good family, what then is a bodhisattva's right mindfulness? It is mindfulness of the awakening mind, mindfulness of generosity, mindfulness of moral discipline, mindfulness of patience, mindfulness of diligence, mindfulness of meditative concentration, mindfulness of wisdom, and mindfulness of loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity. This is called right mindfulness.

O son of good family, furthermore, a bodhisattva's right mindfulness is: the mindfulness through which one does not give occasion to any affliction whatsoever; the mindfulness through which one does not give occasion to any deed of *māra*; the mindfulness through which one does not stray from the path and does not fall into a wrong path; and the mindfulness that has become like a gatekeeper, through which one does not give occasion to any unwholesome mental phenomena — whether of mind or of mental factors arising from mind. This is called right mindfulness.

Furthermore, a bodhisattva's right mindfulness is the mindfulness through which, even upon attaining the excellent and faultless lineage together with perfect mindfulness, one does not actualize the fruit directly. O son of good family, this is a bodhisattva's right mindfulness.

O son of good family, what then is a bodhisattva's right meditative absorption (*samādhi*)? It is the meditative absorption that has become a noble liberation: consonant with the thorough understanding of the truth of suffering, consonant with the abandonment of the truth of the origin of suffering, consonant with the actualization of the truth of cessation, and consonant with the cultivation of the truth of the path. This is called right meditative absorption.

Because the self is sameness, all phenomena are sameness; because the self is thoroughly pure, all phenomena are thoroughly pure; because the self is emptiness, one enters meditative equipoise into all phenomena as emptiness. One who so enters, and enters into what is truly real, yet does not fall into definite deliverance — this is a bodhisattva's right meditative absorption.

The right meditative absorption through which, by means of the wisdom conjoined with a single moment of mind, one fully and perfectly awakens to omniscience and to the primordial wisdom of knowledge of all aspects — this, O son of good family, is called a bodhisattva's right meditative absorption. And this is the thoroughly pure conduct of the bodhisattva path.

When this thoroughly pure conduct of the Dharma factors conducive to awakening was taught, sixty-six thousand gods, humans, and living beings who were committed to the śrāvaka vehicle but had not yet entered into definitive certainty gave rise to the mind of unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening.

This is the third and final fascicle.

Then the Blessed One again addressed the bodhisattva, the great being Ratnakūṭa, and declared: Son of good family, what is the thoroughly pure conduct of a bodhisattva's superknowledge (abhijñā)? Son of good family, here the thoroughly pure conduct of a bodhisattva's superknowledge of the divine eye is endowed with five aspects. What are those five aspects? They are as follows.

Obtaining luminosity by gazing in all ten directions — this is that bodhisattva's divine eye.

Being free from darkness and deep darkness by gazing rightly upon all the buddhas of the ten directions — this is that bodhisattva's divine eye.

Examining with great precision the death and rebirth of all sentient beings — this is that bodhisattva's divine eye.

Being magnificently adorned by gazing rightly upon the visible forms, colors, marks, and shapes of all the ten directions — this is that bodhisattva's divine eye.

Having accomplished one's own splendor, so that as a defining mark of non-fabrication one surpasses the heads of all gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, śrāvakas, and pratyekabuddhas — this is that bodhisattva's divine eye.

Son of good family, these five aspects constitute the thoroughly pure conduct of a bodhisattva's superknowledge of the divine eye.

The thoroughly pure conduct of that bodhisattva's superknowledge of the divine ear is endowed with five aspects. What are those five aspects? They

are: that by which one comes to hear the sounds of humans; that by which one comes to hear the sounds of non-humans; that by which one comes to hear the sounds of beings in the hells, beings born in the animal realm, and beings in the world of Yama; that by which one comes to hear all the sounds of the Dharma taught by the buddhas; and that by which one comes to hear all the voices and sounds of the ten directions. Son of good family, these are the five aspects of the thoroughly pure conduct of a bodhisattva's superknowledge of the divine ear.

The thoroughly pure conduct of that bodhisattva's superknowledge of knowing others' minds is endowed with five aspects. What are those five aspects? They are: fully knowing whatever minds arose at the beginning for all sentient beings — gods, humans, beings in the hells, beings born in the animal realm, and beings in the world of Yama; fully knowing whatever minds will arise at the end; fully knowing whatever minds arise in the present moment; fully knowing the mental conduct of sentient beings whose minds have causes and conditions, have an object, are determinate or indeterminate, are determined toward wrongness, or are determined toward rightness; and fully knowing the mental conduct of beings who conduct themselves through attachment, those who conduct themselves through aversion, those who conduct themselves through delusion, and those who conduct themselves in a balanced manner — and having so known, teaching the Dharma to each in accordance with suchness and in accord with their condition. Son of good family, these are the five aspects of the thoroughly pure conduct of a bodhisattva's superknowledge of knowing others' minds.

The thoroughly pure conduct of that bodhisattva's superknowledge of recollecting previous abodes is endowed with five aspects. What are those five aspects? They are: minds that arose from the cause of attachment,

and also recollecting whatever kinds of bodies those minds had taken up; minds that arose from the cause of generosity, and those that arose from the cause of moral discipline, and those that arose from the cause of loving-kindness, and those that arose from the cause of compassion, and those that arose from the cause of meditative absorption — and also recollecting whatever kinds of bodies those minds had taken up; minds that are unlike their cause, and those that are unlike their condition, and those that are unlike their object — and also recollecting whatever kinds of bodies those minds had taken up; minds that are morally indeterminate, and those thoroughly comprised of ignorance and delusion — and also recollecting

whatever kinds of bodies those minds had taken up; and recollecting what lifespan, what complexion, what form, what splendor, what retinue, what power, what renown, what speech, and what sovereignty those minds came to possess. Son of good family, these are the five aspects of the thoroughly pure conduct of a bodhisattva's superknowledge of recollecting previous abodes.

That bodhisattva's thoroughly pure conduct of the superknowledge of miraculous power is endowed with five aspects. What are those five aspects? They are: the miraculous power of displaying bodies and forms, the miraculous power of making words and sounds known, the miraculous power of arousing mind and mentation, the miraculous power of making itself known in the language of all sentient beings, and the miraculous power of not manifestly constructing anything. The thoroughly pure conduct of the superknowledge of miraculous power is endowed with these five aspects. Son of good family, these are the five aspects of the thoroughly pure conduct of a bodhisattva's superknowledge of miraculous power.

Son of good family, furthermore, what is examined with the eye of wisdom is the thoroughly pure conduct of a bodhisattva's superknowledge of the divine eye. What is thoroughly established in consciousness is the thoroughly pure conduct of the superknowledge of the divine ear. What is thoroughly established in thorough natural purity is the thoroughly pure conduct of the superknowledge of knowing others' minds. What is thoroughly established in thoroughly cutting through the extremes of the past and the future is the thoroughly pure conduct of the superknowledge of recollecting previous abodes. What is thoroughly established in non-construction is the thoroughly pure conduct of the superknowledge of the four bases of miraculous power.

Son of good family, the very term "superknowledges" is an epithet of the wisdom of the exhaustion of defilements. Son of good family, thus a bodhisattva plays freely with those five superknowledges and yet also dwells in the wisdom of the exhaustion of defilements.

Son of good family, consider this example. There is a great city that must be reached by traveling ten billion leagues. The road to that great city is difficult to traverse, long, and desolate — filled with danger, and without food, drink, or provisions. Yet one who arrives at that great city will find all their suffering cut off and ended. Then a certain person, upon hearing the true qualities and praises of that great city, has a single child — one who is dear, beloved, pleasing, and without fault in his eyes. That person, setting aside that one

child, sets out on the road to the great city. With all the force of his strength and diligence, he transcends every hardship, traverses that long road, and places one foot on the very threshold of the great city's gate.

With one foot still outside, he remembers his only child and thinks to himself: "Alas! I have not brought my only child here with me. Would that he were here with me now!" And out of love for that only child, instead of entering the great city, he turns back in the opposite direction and returns to wherever his only child is waiting.

In just this same way, a son of good family, a bodhisattva, a great being, through great exertion, through great and strenuous diligence, and through the steady and earnest application of superior intention, brings forth the five higher knowledges. By training the mind to full perfection in meditative concentration and the higher knowledges, the gnosis of the exhaustion of defilements would come directly before him. But he, having aroused the mind of great compassion in order to fully protect all sentient beings, and having drawn close to the gnosis of the exhaustion of defilements, turns back and looks upon sentient beings, returns once more, and continues to appear even at the level of ordinary beings.

Son of good family, the phrase "great city" is a synonym for the gnosis of the exhaustion of defilements. The phrase "a journey of hundreds of thousands of myriads of leagues" is a synonym for taking hold of immeasurable saṃsāra. The phrase "traversed by many obstacles" is a synonym for the obstacles of overcoming māra's deeds and intentions. The phrase "a certain person" is a synonym for a bodhisattva. The phrase "one foot placed on the threshold of the city's gate and one foot still outside" means the following: it refers to the entry of the bodhisattva's mind and mental factors, which are a mixture of conditioned and unconditioned. The phrase "remembering his only child and turning back from entering the great city, returning once more" means the following: it refers to the fact that the bodhisattva comes to dwell with loving-kindness toward all sentient beings as though each were his only child. Though that bodhisattva has reached the very summit of the gnosis of the exhaustion of defilements, he does not abandon the defilements, and turns back once more in order to bring all sentient beings to full maturation. Thus, sons of good family, behold how great the compassion of bodhisattvas is toward sentient beings, and how supremely skillful their means.

Then the great bodhisattva Ratnakūṭa addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, it is wondrous that these bodhisattvas, these great beings, without even seeking awakening within their grasp, enter again and again into saṃsāra itself and bring sentient beings to full maturation — and yet never grow weary. Blessed One, with what qualities endowed are bodhisattvas, these great beings, unwearying while in saṃsāra?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, when bodhisattvas, great beings, are endowed with twenty qualities, they are unwearying while in saṃsāra. And what are those twenty? They are as follows: great loving-kindness properly held by the root of virtue; great compassion properly held by great loving-kindness; the ripening of sentient beings properly held by great compassion; diligence properly held by the activity of ripening sentient beings; superior intention properly held by diligence; skillful means properly held by superior intention; wisdom properly held by skillful means; meditative concentration properly held by wisdom; higher knowledge properly held by meditative concentration; gnosis properly held by higher knowledge; gentleness properly held by gnosis; mindfulness properly held by gentleness; the superior intention of the awakening mind properly held by mindfulness;

the four means of gathering sentient beings properly held by the superior intention of the awakening mind; the vow of moral discipline properly held by the four means of gathering; diligent study properly held by the vow of moral discipline; dhāraṇī properly held by diligent study; eloquence properly held by dhāraṇī; the accumulation of merit properly held by eloquence; and the accumulation of wisdom properly held by the accumulation of merit. Son of good family, if a bodhisattva, a great being, is endowed with these twenty qualities of Dharma, he will never grow weary in saṃsāra.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Ratnacūṭa, again addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how does a bodhisattva, a great being, become resplendent in saṃsāra and bring benefit to the many?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, a bodhisattva becomes resplendent in saṃsāra through learning adorned with merit. He brings benefit to the many through eloquence adorned with learning. Son of good family, furthermore, a bodhisattva becomes resplendent in saṃsāra through dhāraṇī that brings the attainment of unfailing mindfulness. He brings benefit to the many through inexhaustible wealth held in his hands. Son of good family, furthermore, a bodhisattva becomes resplendent in saṃsāra through

heedfulness. He brings benefit to the many through tireless teaching of the Dharma. Son of good family, furthermore, a bodhisattva becomes resplendent in saṃsāra through being beautifully adorned with the major marks. He brings benefit to the many through being adorned with gnosis. Son of good family, furthermore, a bodhisattva becomes resplendent in saṃsāra by doing exactly as he has said. He brings benefit to the many through that very consistency of word and deed. Son of good family, furthermore, a bodhisattva becomes resplendent in saṃsāra through giving away all his possessions completely. He brings benefit to the many through teaching the Dharma to each one according to what is fitting. Son of good family, furthermore, a bodhisattva becomes resplendent in saṃsāra through perfectly pure moral discipline. He brings benefit to the many through perfectly pure learning. Son of good family, you should understand through this enumeration how it is that through heedfulness a bodhisattva becomes resplendent in saṃsāra and brings benefit to the many.

Son of good family, in a time long past, beyond innumerable aeons — more than innumerable, vast, immeasurable, and inconceivable — at that time, in the aeon called Joyful, in the world-system called Surveyed by Gods, a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha appeared in the world — one endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one — by the name Universally Delighting All Worlds.

Son of good family, why was that aeon called Joyful? Son of good family, in that aeon sixty thousand buddhas appeared. And the gods of the Pure Abode realm proclaimed with a cry of joy, saying: 'O friends, this is a good aeon; in this aeon sixty thousand buddhas will appear!' And the world together with its gods heard that joyful cry. Having heard it, great joy, faith, and devotion arose,

Then those gods and humans said, "Ah, this aeon has become joyful!" And because they spoke those words, the name Joyful was given to that aeon.

Son of good family, that world-realm was so beautiful to behold, so delightful in its splendor, that even all the gods could gaze upon it without ever becoming sated. For this reason that world-realm was called Seen with Delight by the Gods.

Son of good family, the ground of that world-realm called Seen with Delight by the Gods was made entirely of the heartwood of sandalwood serpents. A single measure of that sandalwood heartwood dust could not be purchased for the price of a thousand world-realms. The fragrance of incense wafting from that world-realm pervaded immeasurable and uncountable world-realms in all ten directions. Upon that great earth formed of sandalwood serpent heartwood there arose only great lotuses called Luminous Net of Rays, and the light of those lotuses perpetually illuminated that world-realm. Those humans too dwelt in multi-storied mansions fashioned from sandalwood dust, adorned beautifully with porticos, gatehouses, corridors, and stairways. In that world-realm there were no villages, towns, or hamlets. All those humans moved through the sky. Having fully attained supernormal powers (*abhijñā*), they entered into multi-storied mansions stationed in the midst of the sky and traveled through the air. In that world-realm there was no dwelling in the womb; all those humans were born by spontaneous birth only. The very name of woman was not heard there. There were no lower states of existence, no bad rebirths, no suffering. In that world-realm there was no coarse food. All those humans were sustained by the food of the joy of supernormal powers and meditative concentration (*dhyāna*). They had entered the Great Vehicle with fervent and vast aspiration, and the name of any other vehicle was not heard there. All the humans of that world-realm wore golden crowns and were adorned with shoulder ornaments and earrings; they all possessed the complexion and form of gods. The very fact of being free from afflictions was itself their going forth into renunciation. That Tathāgata, the Blessed One, never commanded those bodhisattvas to wear saffron robes, for their minds were entirely without turbidity. That Tathāgata taught the Dharma to those bodhisattvas with a conduct supremely serene, like the conduct of Brahmā.

Son of good family, the bodhisattvas of great miraculous power from all ten directions also came to that world-realm called Seen with Delight by the Gods in order to behold, pay homage to, and honor that Blessed One, that Tathāgata Universally Delighting All Worlds. Upon seeing the array of excellent qualities of that buddha-field, they were filled with wonder and departed reciting verses of praise.

Son of good family, when that Tathāgata Universally Delighting All Worlds taught the Dharma to those bodhisattvas, he would rise up into the sky to a height of eighty palm trees and, seated upon a lion throne adorned with an array of Brahmā's ornaments, teach the Dharma. Son of good family, that

Tathāgata did not teach the Dharma as a discursive verbal discourse elaborated at length in the way I do now; that Tathāgata taught the Dharma in brief with few words and syllables. And why was that? Those noble beings needed only a hint to understand; a single word was sufficient for them to follow the meaning of a hundred thousand words. That Tathāgata was like this: the conduct of the perfections perfectly purified, the conduct of the qualities pertaining to awakening perfectly purified, the conduct of accomplishing the direct knowledges perfectly purified, and the conduct of ripening sentient beings perfectly purified — these four kinds of perfectly purified conduct the bodhisattva Ratnaśara expounded correctly and thoroughly.

Then the bodhisattva and great being Ratnaśara addressed the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Sarvalokābhirata, with these words: "Blessed One, how does a bodhisattva become radiant in saṃsāra and come to sustain the welfare of the many?" The Tathāgata then explained that very statement at length and declared to him: "Son of good family, a bodhisattva with unobstructed gnosis is radiant in saṃsāra. One who has fully attained the radiance of gnosis comes to sustain the welfare of the many."

Son of good family, when that Tathāgata Sarvalokābhirata had taught in this way, sixty thousand bodhisattvas attained acceptance concordant with phenomena.

Son of good family, then the bodhisattva and great being Ratnaśara again addressed the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Sarvalokābhirata, with these words: "Blessed One, how does a bodhisattva adorn the essence of awakening?" When this was asked, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Sarvalokābhirata, declared to the bodhisattva and great being Ratnaśara: "Son of good family, it is heedfulness that adorns the essence of awakening for a bodhisattva. And what is heedfulness? It is the extent to which one accomplishes the Dharma teachings. And what does accomplishing the Dharma teachings mean? It is this: acting in accordance with what one has said. This is called heedfulness.

Son of good family, furthermore, the heedfulness of a bodhisattva is as follows: boundless preparation carried to its utmost, and thereby taking up boundless armour; gathering boundless sentient beings, and thereby boundless inexhaustible generosity; moral discipline that is unwavering and follows in the wake of the buddha lineage, and thereby boundless moral discipline; accepting all suffering, and thereby boundless patience; the deeds of the excellent person, and thereby boundless diligence; accomplishing

boundless meditative absorption, and thereby boundless dhyāna; for the sake of non-attached wisdom, and thereby boundless wisdom; because of boundless sentient beings, boundless loving-kindness; through the actuality of benefit, boundless compassion; by genuinely accomplishing the qualities of a buddha, boundless retention of saṃsāra; through non-attachment to one's own happiness, boundless ripening of sentient beings; through firm diligence, boundless upholding of the sacred Dharma; through genuine engagement, genuinely accomplishing and amassing boundless qualities; through boundless gnosis, boundless veneration and service to buddhas; through refinement of wisdom, boundless seeking of learning; through knowing the disposition of sentient beings' minds, boundless entering into minds; through determined loving-kindness, boundless engagement in imparting cultivated qualities and provisions; through taming the mind, a boundless accumulation of qualities arising from dwelling in solitude;

through swiftly perfecting the gnosis of omniscience, boundless accumulations of calm abiding and insight.

These are the qualities, O Jewel Meteor of the Dharma, that constitute the practice of heedfulness.

O noble son, the heedfulness of a bodhisattva beautifies the heart of awakening. O noble son, heedfulness is the root of all the qualities that belong to the side of awakening. Heedfulness is the ground of all qualities that accomplish gnosis. Heedfulness is that which individually and correctly holds all the wholesome qualities one has gathered and goes on gathering. Heedfulness is that which prevents the Dharma one has previously heard from being wasted. Heedfulness is that which gathers all qualities fit to be gathered. Heedfulness is that which does not gather qualities that obscure. Heedfulness is that which firmly retains all qualities that do not lead to obscuration. Heedfulness shatters the door-frame of ignorance. Heedfulness causes the upholding of the sacred Dharma to blaze forth. Heedfulness restrains the sense faculties. Heedfulness guards against all conduct that leads to peril on the path. Heedfulness rouses action away from conduct that is both timely and untimely. Heedfulness is power itself — it will fully perfect the ten powers. Heedfulness is overwhelming mastery — it will fully perfect the four fearlessnesses. Heedfulness is the inexhaustible wellspring of immeasurable qualities and gnosis — it will fully perfect all the qualities of a buddha. Heedfulness is the crown — it will realise the gnosis of omniscience.

O noble son, while the Tathāgata Sarvalokābhirata was giving this kind of teaching, twelve thousand bodhisattvas attained the supreme acceptance of the unborn nature of phenomena. O noble son, do not now harbour any doubt, hesitation, or second thought that the bodhisattva Jewel Meteor of the Dharma at that time and on that occasion was someone other than yourself. It was not so. Why? Because, O noble son, you yourself were at that time and on that occasion the bodhisattva known as Jewel Meteor of the Dharma.

O noble son, by this further account you should understand how the bodhisattva mahāsattva who is heedful beautifies the heart of awakening, and that the awakening of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, is also attained through heedfulness.

O noble son, what then is the perfectly pure conduct of a bodhisattva through which sentient beings are fully matured? O noble son, the conduct of sentient beings is immeasurable, boundless, and inconceivable; and in just the same way, the conduct of a bodhisattva through which sentient beings are fully matured is likewise immeasurable, boundless, and inconceivable. In this regard, a bodhisattva who knows the intentions of sentient beings is able to mature them fully. Why? Because, O noble son, some sentient beings are fully matured through moral discipline; some through the abandonment of moral discipline. Some sentient beings are fully matured through being instructed in the most pointed words; some through gentle words; some through harsh words; some through both together. Some through being made to fear; some through being completely released from fear. Some through being roused; some through not being roused. Some through harm; some through not being harmed. Some through being overwhelmed; some through not being overwhelmed. Some through being refined; some through not being refined. Some through being reprimanded; some through giving in the spirit of generosity; some through receiving. Some sentient beings are fully matured through the presentation of a pleasing form. Some sentient beings through sound, through fragrance, through taste, through touch,

through a pleasing mental object being presented to them, are fully matured. Some sentient beings are fully matured through an unpleasing form being presented to them. Some sentient beings are fully matured through unpleasing sound, fragrance, taste, touch, and mental objects being presented to them. Some sentient beings are fully matured through ridicule. Some through always being seen, and some through not being seen. Some sentient beings through the word "buddha," some through the word "Dharma," some

through the word "Saṅgha," some through the word "impermanence," some through the word "suffering," some through the word "selflessness," some through the word "peace." Some sentient beings are fully matured through the words "generosity," "moral discipline," "patience," "diligence," "meditative concentration," and "wisdom." Some sentient beings are fully matured through words describing the suffering to be experienced in the hells, in the realm of animals, and in the world of the Lord of Death. Some are fully matured through words describing the happiness to be experienced among the gods. Some sentient beings are fully matured through teachings on the vehicle of the śrāvakas, some through teachings on the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, and some through teachings on the Great Vehicle.

Some sentient beings are fully matured through generosity alone, and not through pleasing speech, nor through beneficial conduct, nor through consistency of purpose. Some sentient beings are fully matured through pleasing speech alone, and not through generosity, nor through beneficial conduct, nor through consistency of purpose. Some sentient beings are fully matured through beneficial conduct alone, and not through generosity, nor through pleasing speech, nor through consistency of purpose. Some sentient beings are fully matured through consistency of purpose alone, and not through generosity, nor through pleasing speech, nor through beneficial conduct. Some sentient beings are fully matured through all four of the means of gathering disciples together.

Some sentient beings are fully matured through relinquishing inner possessions, some through relinquishing outer possessions, and some through relinquishing both inner and outer possessions. Some sentient beings are fully matured through giving up their wives, sons, and daughters entirely. Some sentient beings are fully matured through giving up their hands, feet, eyes, and head. Some sentient beings are fully matured through love of play, song, and music. Some through pure pleasure, some through pure suffering, some through both of these, and some through neither of them.

Some sentient beings are tamed by appearing as an ascetic; some are tamed by appearing as a monk, a nun, a layman, or a laywoman. Some sentient beings are tamed by the form and color of a buddha — for those, taming comes through displaying the form and body of a buddha.

Noble son, knowing in this way that sentient beings engage in all manner of conduct, a bodhisattva must strive to fully understand the intentions of

sentient beings. Noble son, when a bodhisattva has gained certainty through the practice of the perfections, has gathered together the dharmas that are factors conducive to awakening, and has become skilled in the practice of the wisdom of direct knowledge, only then does he have the fortune and the power to be able to fully mature sentient beings.

Noble son, a bodhisattva who possesses four qualities is able to fully mature sentient beings. What are the four? They are: being utterly inexhaustible, not being attached to one's own comfort, exhorting others at the right time and the wrong time alike, and fully understanding the intentions of beings. Noble son, when a bodhisattva possesses these four qualities, he is able to fully mature sentient beings.

Noble son, furthermore, a bodhisattva who possesses four qualities is able to fully mature sentient beings. What are the four? They are: being easy to instruct, speaking pleasantly, being gentle in manner, and being smiling and without a furrowed brow. Noble son, when a bodhisattva possesses these four qualities, he is able to fully mature sentient beings.

Noble son, furthermore, a bodhisattva who possesses four qualities is able to fully mature sentient beings. What are the four? They are: a mind free of anger, a mind of great compassion, a mind oriented toward benefit, and a mind that is utterly tamed. Noble son, when a bodhisattva possesses these four qualities, he is able to fully mature sentient beings.

Noble son, furthermore, a bodhisattva who possesses four qualities is able to fully mature sentient beings. What are the four? They are: pure intention, being without deceit and free from guile, steadfast diligence, and the patient acceptance of both good treatment and harm. Noble son, when a bodhisattva possesses these four qualities, he is able to fully mature sentient beings.

Noble son, you should also understand this further synonym: a bodhisattva who is utterly inexhaustible is able to fully mature sentient beings.

Noble son, in a time long past — more than countless, immeasurable, boundless, inconceivable eons ago — during the eon called Delightful, in the world-realm called Peaceful, there arose in the world a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and completely awakened buddha endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, a knower of the world, an unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, a teacher of gods and humans — a Blessed One, a Tathāgata, known by the name Immaculate Radiance. Noble son, that world-realm called

Peaceful was prosperous, flourishing, happy, blessed with good harvests, delightful, and filled to abundance with gods and humans.

Noble son, that Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened Blessed One Immaculate Radiance had a gathering of śrāvakas — great śrāvakas numbering nine hundred and sixty million. His bodhisattvas, the great beings, numbered eighty-four thousand. The lifespan of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Immaculate Radiance, and of those bodhisattvas, was eighty-four thousand years.

Noble son, at that time there appeared a young prince named Glorious Wealth — handsome, attractive, pleasing to behold, of excellent and radiant complexion, endowed with excellence in every way. When he had reached the age of sixteen, intoxicated and made arrogant by his handsome appearance, his wealth, and his pleasures, he grew haughty and proud, and would not go before the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Immaculate Radiance, would not attend upon him, would not approach him, and would not pay him reverence.

Noble son, thereupon the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Immaculate Radiance, reflected thus: "This young prince Glorious Wealth has wholesome roots that have fully matured, and he has the fortune to realize unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening — yet here he is, intoxicated and made arrogant by his appearance, his wealth, and his pleasures.

"Pride has kept him from coming before the Tathāgata, yet if he were urged on without respite, it is possible that he might come before the Tathāgata in the end." And so, noble son, the Tathāgata Immaculate Radiance assembled those eighty-four thousand bodhisattvas. Having assembled them, he addressed them: "Noble sons, who among you would, with tireless and unwearied mind, for eighty-four thousand years go to the gate of the young prince Glorious Wealth's home, giving up all comfort and willingly enduring all suffering, and moreover be willing — even if someone speaks ill of you, slanders you, or insults you with harsh and offensive words from atop a seat they will not even yield to you — to endure it gladly?" And so he examined them.

Noble son, even though he examined them in this way, not a single one among those eighty-four thousand bodhisattvas proved willing. The Blessed One then took up the examination and pressed them a second and third time, yet still not one came forward.

Noble son, at that very moment a certain bodhisattva, a great being, named Blazing Diligence, who had gathered in that very assembly of bodhisattvas,

rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee upon the ground, and with palms joined in reverence toward the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Immaculate Radiance, addressed him thus: "Blessed One, I myself will, with tireless and unwearied mind, for eighty-four thousand years give up all comfort and endure all suffering gladly, and go to the home of the young prince Glorious Wealth."

Noble son, the moment the bodhisattva, the great being Blazing Diligence spoke those words, the great trichiliocosm shook in six ways, and a hundred thousand divine sons from the sky above sent down this proclamation: "Excellent, excellent! The bodhisattva Blazing Diligence has donned the armor of great diligence!"

Noble son, the bodhisattva, the great being Blazing Diligence then went to the home of the young prince Glorious Wealth and stationed himself at the gate. Upon seeing him there, that great crowd of people reviled him and spoke many harsh and offensive words. They threw dirt and dust at him. They struck him with their hands, with sticks, and with clods of earth. Though he saw and heard all this, and though it touched and was felt by his body, the bodhisattva Blazing Diligence was not disturbed, did not grow angry, did not become wrathful, and did not turn back. On the contrary, he roused the full power of steadfast diligence, abided in that power, and generated great compassion.

After a thousand years had passed he entered the first gatehouse of the royal palace. After ten thousand years he entered the second. After twenty thousand years he entered the third. And so it continued until, after seventy thousand years, he had entered the sixth gatehouse of the royal palace. Then, when eighty-four thousand years had passed and he had entered the seventh and innermost gatehouse of the royal palace, the young prince Glorious Wealth at last addressed him: "Monk, what do you wish? What do you seek? Tell me what you need, and I shall give it to the best of my ability."

The young prince conceived a powerful sense of wonder at the monk, marveling at how the monk had been able to sustain his unwearying patience for so long. Then, son of good family, the great bodhisattva Blazing Diligence, perceiving that the mind of the young prince Glorious Wealth was fully serene, spoke these verses:

Food and drink and clothing and provisions —
for me, young prince, there is not the slightest need.
With a mind set free of all material concern,

I have come here as a messenger of Dharma.

One who works the world's good, a great sage arisen,
called Spotless Radiance, most excellent of men —
he teaches the Dharma that brings suffering to its end,
and those sentient beings who hear it shall attain deathlessness.

In an inconceivable number of countless thousands of aeons
buddhas arise perhaps a hundred times in all.

Yet now, a lamp in the world's darkness has appeared:
if one possessed of such supreme virtue is born,

while you, here, are clinging to the pleasures of desire,
forever intoxicated by fine forms and enjoyments,
drunk with delight and equally drunk with kingship,
you will not go to see the King of Dharma.

Enjoyments are impermanent, and so too is a kingdom's life —
like a dewdrop on a blade of grass, so the Victor has declared.
One who, even upon hearing of a buddha, becomes intoxicated —
that one, O prince, is not on your side.

Enter here into the supreme path of awakening
and care for sentient beings, working to set them free.
If you remain now a servant of desire,
how, in your drunkenness, could you tame others?

Abandon pride, dispel all the afflictions,
and go now into the presence of the Victor.
Arouse diligence, show the world your compassion —
in times to come, beings will be tormented and in need.

Upon hearing these verses, the prince cast aside his pride,
gave rise to deep reverence, and bowed at the feet
of Blazing Diligence, saying:

Please forgive whatever harm I caused you before.

I will renounce the entire kingdom
and seek neither desires nor any possessions at all.
Casting off the fault of pride and its arrogance,
I will swiftly go into the presence of the Sugata.

And so, surrounded by eighty million living creatures,
bearing flowers, food offerings, incense, and fragrant smoke,
the prince went to the presence of that supreme being,
Spotless Radiance, that Victor.

Arriving before the Sugata, he bowed at his feet,
made offerings, and sat in the presence of that Tathāgata.
Then the prince spoke these words:

Because he urged me with a spirit free of weariness,
Blazing Diligence, my teacher and protector —
since he is worthy of such veneration,
I cannot repay his kindness as I ought.

I ask the Protector of the World to forgive me:
all the ways I failed in reverence to the King of Dharma —
each and every one of them I confess this day.
May the Protector of the World know my transgression.

With compassion aroused for the sake of sentient beings,
I now enter fully upon the supreme path of awakening.
Until I have attained the most sublime awakening,
I will henceforth never behave with heedlessness.

The prince then entirely abandoned his kingdom and, surrounded by eighty million sentient beings, seeking this supreme awakening, he went forth into the Victor's teaching, which had manifestly arisen before them. The Victor, knowing the intentions of all of them, taught clearly the supreme path of awakening, and all those sentient beings who heard the Dharma, being forever pure, every one of them attained concordant patience.

Son of good family, I could speak in praise of the world-realm of that Tathāgata Spotless Radiance for an aeon or even more than an aeon,

and even if one were to recount in full the inconceivable Dharma that was taught there, the store of its excellent qualities would never be exhausted.

Son of good family, do not harbour doubt, suspicion, or uncertainty, thinking that the bodhisattva known at that time and on that occasion as Blazing Diligence was someone other than who you might suppose. Do not look upon it so. And why? Because at that time and on that occasion, I myself was the one who had become that bodhisattva known as Blazing Diligence.

Son of good family, do not harbour doubt, suspicion, or uncertainty, thinking that the young prince known at that time and on that occasion as Glorious Treasure was someone other than who you might suppose. Do not look upon it so. And why? Because the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya (Loving-Kindness, the future buddha) was the one who had become that young prince known as Glorious Treasure at that time and on that occasion.

Son of good family, thus did the bodhisattvas of former times, without ever growing weary in the work of bringing sentient beings to full maturation, demonstrate diligence in this way, endowed with immense strength. Therefore, son of good family, a bodhisattva who wishes to bring sentient beings to full maturation must by all means train in the manner of that bodhisattva known as Blazing Diligence. And why? Because, son of good family, bringing sentient beings to full maturation is the very work of bodhisattvas.

Son of good family, these four are the bodhisattva deeds of bodhisattvas through which all the qualities of a buddha are gathered. What are the four? They are: transcending the deeds of māra — this is a bodhisattva deed; thoroughly purifying buddha-fields — this is a bodhisattva deed; adorning body, speech, and mind — this is a bodhisattva deed; and perfectly accomplishing all the qualities of a buddha — this is a bodhisattva deed. Son of good family, these four are the bodhisattva deeds of bodhisattvas through which all the qualities of a buddha are gathered.

Son of good family, there are also a further four bodhisattva deeds of bodhisattvas through which all the qualities of a buddha are perfectly gathered. What are the four? They are: the wisdom (jñāna) that enters into the intentions of beings; the wisdom that fully comprehends the faculties of beings; the wisdom of giving medicine that pacifies all illness; and the unperturbed wisdom that perfectly pacifies the illness of all afflictions. Son of good family, these four are the bodhisattva deeds of bodhisattvas through which all the qualities of a buddha are perfectly gathered.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, Precious Crown Jewel took the precious crown jewel atop his head — that jewel perfected through roots of virtue accumulated over incalculable, innumerable, immeasurable tens of millions of hundreds of thousands of aeons, a jewel of such surpassing worth that even the ten world-systems of a great trichiliocosm filled to the brim with the seven precious substances could not match its price — and offered it to the

Tathāgata. He then spoke these words:

Blessed One, by this root of virtue accrued through offering to the Tathāgata this precious jewel from atop my head, may I attain that which is not seen at the very crown — the unseen summit of the head — and may I come to possess the inconceivable gnosis of buddhahood arisen as the crown of my own being.

Thereupon the Blessed One smiled. This is the nature of reality (dharmatā) of the blessed buddhas: whenever a Blessed One smiles, rays of light in manifold and varied colours issue forth from the Blessed One's mouth — blue, yellow, red, white, the colour of crystal, and colours resembling silver —

These rays of light pervaded those boundless and infinite world-systems, rose up as far as the Brahmā worlds, and utterly extinguished even the splendour of the moon and sun. Then they turned back, circumambulated the Blessed One many hundreds and thousands of times, and came to rest at the crown of the Blessed One's head.

Thereupon the bodhisattva named Swift Boldness rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee upon the ground, turned toward the Blessed One, joined his palms, and in verses set to a melodious air asked the meaning of the smile the Blessed One had displayed.

O supreme one, peerless among the peerless, eye of the world, best of the world,

O sovereign son of the Śākya, with faculties serene, who has relinquished the triple defilement,

Incomparable, surpassing comparison, exalted by loving-kindness, Victor like Mount Meru —

For what reason did you smile? O source of gnosis, please grant me a prophecy.

Free of deceit, supremely gentle, with speech that is most sweet,

Holy being, greatest giver of joy, with supreme mindfulness and an enlightened heart,

Sugata, most excellent in aspiration, true one worshipped by gods and humans —

Please reveal, through the benefit you bestow, why you have displayed this smile.

Possessed of the ten powers, with the radiance, merit, and splendour of one whose stride is light,

You who roar supremely in the assembly like a lion and vanquish all opponents,

O Sage, in the three realms of existence none is equal to you, nor is any greater.

O sovereign of Dharma, please make known why you have displayed this smile.

With a face of utter purity, supremely joyful and perfectly delighted,

Moving through the sky like the moon, blazing forth in all ten directions,

Dispelling darkness, crushing dust, with light and glory spreading wide —

O Sugata, who display this smile, please speak and show the benefit you bestow.

Shining like a mountain of gold, accomplished in discipline, radiating merit and gnosis,

Ever praised by the wise, worthy of the world's wonder and worship,

Supreme in existence, transcending the world, an inexhaustible field of giving,

Display the smile of the Śākya lion as it blazes upon the face of the sky.

None like you is worshipped by gods and humans, nor does such a one exist even in the divine realms,

Your mind is even, your aspiration is even, you abound with the glory of conscience and integrity,

Your marks are supremely complete, blazing with a hundred virtues in full perfection —

O Sugata, who has displayed a smile, O supreme Sage, please speak.

Your gnosis reaches constantly and unobstructedly into the three times,

You know in an instant the mind and mentation, the faculties, and the intentions of all sentient beings,

You know immediately what every single sentient being intends —

O lion of men, for what reason have you smiled? Please tell me the purpose, speak it to me.

The many gods dwelling in the sky too are supremely gladdened in their minds,

The multitude of humans on the ground bow their heads and make prostration —

Whatever is heard dispels for gods and humans the dust of darkness.

O best of men, please open wide the supreme taste of the nectar.

When these words had been spoken, the Blessed One addressed the bodhisattva, the great being Swift Boldness, saying: Son of good family, did you see how this bodhisattva Jewel-Crest offered this precious jewel from the crown of his head to the Tathāgata so that the inconceivable gnosis of buddhahood might arise as the crown of his being?

He replied: Blessed One, I saw it.

The Blessed One declared: Son of good family, by means of this jewel of Jewel-Crest, the bodhisattva, the great being, pleased buddha Blessed Ones as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges, served them, honoured them, and made images of them and worshipped them, and everywhere lived the pure and holy life. Thereby he also brought immeasurable sentient beings to full maturation in the three vehicles.

Son of good family, in a hundred thousand immeasurable aeons hence, in a stainless aeon, in the world-realm called Stainless Light, a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans — a Blessed One buddha named Jewel-Arising — will appear in the world. The ground of that world-realm called Stainless Light will become the seven precious jewels. The light that arises from that world-realm will illuminate the innumerable buddha-fields of the ten directions. That light will be the colour of gold. Whatever sentient beings are touched by that light will be tormented by none of their afflictions. That world-realm called Stainless Light will be prosperous, flourishing, and the abode of bodhisattvas alone. There, apart from the bodhisattva jewel, no other kind of jewel will arise — and for that reason the Tathāgata will be named Jewel-Arising. All those bodhisattvas will fully attain the higher knowledges (abhijñā). All their enjoyments and all their conduct will arise by the mere power of thought. All gods and humans who are born in that world-realm will become definitively destined for unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. In that realm, the very names of states without leisure and of the lower destinies will be absent. There, apart from the Blessed One Tathāgata Jewel-Arising, the unsurpassed king of Dharma, no other king will arise. All those gods and humans will be born by miraculous birth. In that world-realm the very names of union with women and of assembly for that purpose will be absent. In that world-realm

there will be no sentient being who is blind, deaf, dull-witted, hunchbacked, or lacking in limbs — all will be beautifully adorned with the marks of body. The bodhisattva Saṅgha of that Tathāgata will be immeasurable. The measure of his lifespan will reach forty-two intermediate aeons. That Tathāgata will teach nothing other than awakening, the perfections, great compassion, and the Great Vehicle. All those bodhisattvas will be so keen in their faculties that they will understand with just a hint. From a single word of a Dharma-gate they will comprehend the awakening of all buddhas. That Tathāgata will also perfectly teach those bodhisattvas the dhāraṇī of vajra-words. What is the dhāraṇī of vajra-words? It is this: entry into all words through a single word. And what is that single word? It is the word that is inexhaustible. And what is that inexhaustible word? The inexhaustible word is that which not even all the buddhas are able to exhaust. And what is that inexhaustible word? It is this: the syllable "A" is the inexhaustible word, for upon entering the syllable "A" one enters into every letter. Thus all letters are inexhaustible — no two letters can be heard in sequence without a preceding and following. Each individual letter is recited on its own, and yet no letter is connected to two letters simultaneously. Therefore that single word itself is the word of clear discernment.

And that word of clear discernment — one does not think of it as "the word of clear discernment," one does not conceptualize it at all. In just this way, that word, being without thought and without conceptual elaboration, accomplishes its purpose. Noble son, this is what it means to enter into the dhāraṇī of the vajra word.

In this way, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Precious Arising, will perfectly teach that dhāraṇī of the vajra word to those bodhisattvas.

Noble son, were I to speak the praises of that world-realm called Immaculate Light for a kalpa or even beyond a kalpa, and were I to fully proclaim the inconceivable Dharma-teaching of the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha Precious Arising, the recounting of his qualities would never be exhausted — for in that buddha-field there arise immeasurable and limitless arrays of qualities of every kind.

Then the bodhisattva mahāsattva Ratnaśikhara, having heard this prophecy spoken of himself, was filled with delight, joy, and elation. A sense of ease and mental happiness arose in him, and he praised the Blessed One with these fitting verses:

Knowing all and seeing all,
gone beyond every dharma,
utterly transcending
every flaw of error —
how wondrous is your great wisdom, O Tathāgata!

Among those many hundreds of millions of buddhas
before whom I have made offerings in former times,
you know each and every one of those offerings fully.

My conduct — past, future,
and present as well —
together with the conduct of every living being:
all of this you know thoroughly, O Sage.

"Just as the Sage is, so shall you become —
a buddha, an awakening being for the world" —
thus has the perfectly awakened Buddha prophesied for me,
and I have not the slightest doubt.

All the great continents might sink,
the sun and moon might fall from the sky —
yet from the mouth of the Blessed One,
no word contrary to truth ever comes forth.

Endowed with wisdom and great discernment,
with words of truth he has proclaimed for me
the supreme prophecy of awakening:
I shall become a peerless buddha.

Since he knows the mind with his own mind,
whatever my conduct is like
and whatever my buddha-field shall be like,
all of this he has fully shown, just as it is.

Having heard the speech of the perfectly awakened Buddha,
I am without doubt and my faculties are satisfied.
For the sake of being a cause of benefit to sentient beings,
I shall undertake the supreme conduct.

Whatever my former conduct was,
purified to its ultimate end —
far beyond even that, immeasurably,

shall I pursue my conduct.

Not passing by this in laziness,
in this conduct of steadfast diligence,
with a mind free from any despondency,
I shall pursue the conduct of awakening.

I have received the prophecy of awakening;
the Buddha has bestowed his inspiration upon me.
For as long as I have not yet become a guide for beings,
I shall not abandon diligence.

Always inclining toward supreme awakening,
I shall care for every sentient being.
Seeking the holy awakening itself —
those beings I shall nurture and sustain.

When the bodhisattva Ratnaśikhara had finished presenting these verses, seventy-two thousand living beings generated the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. With aspiration in their hearts, they voiced this wish to be reborn in the world-realm of Immaculate Light, saying: "When the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Precious Arising, attains awakening, may we too be born in that buddha-field!" And the Blessed One then prophesied that every single one of them would indeed be born in that buddha-field.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up this Dharma-teaching. Master it. Uphold it."

"Memorize it thoroughly. And teach it in full detail to others as well. Ānanda, whatever son or daughter of good family upholds or reads this Dharma-teaching, I prophesy that they will attain unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Ānanda, whatever son or daughter of good family were to make offerings for a thousand years to Tathāgatas, arhats, and perfectly complete buddhas, giving them whatever they desired — even that merit is surpassed by the merit of any son or daughter of good family who hears this Dharma-teaching with faith, upholds it, reads it, and applies it earnestly just as it is. This latter merit is far greater — one should understand it to be immeasurable and innumerable."

Then the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, now that I have received this Dharma-teaching, what is the

name of this Dharma-teaching? How shall I uphold it?"

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, therefore hold this Dharma-teaching under the name 'The Utterly Pure Practice of the Bodhisattva.' Hold it also under the name 'The Intimate Instructions of the Tathāgata.' Hold it also under the name 'The Questions of Ratnacūḍa.'"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the great bodhisattva Ratnacūḍa, all those bodhisattvas, the venerable Ānanda, and the entire world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced, and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

This completes the forty-seventh chapter, "The Questions of Ratnacūḍa," from the hundred-thousand chapters of the noble Great Jewel Heap Dharma-teaching, the Mahāratnakūṭa.

Translated by the Indian abbot Kamalaśīla and the great editor-translator, the monk Dharmataśīla; revised and finalized in the new translation style.

Translator's Notes

- The title compound "Ratnacūḍa" means "Jewel Crest" or "Jewel Crown" — rendered here by its Sanskrit equivalent rather than a literal English translation, as it functions as a proper name throughout the text.

The phrase rendered "bound by just one more birth" translates a technical term indicating bodhisattvas at the final stage before full buddhahood, who will take only one more rebirth before awakening.

The series of bodhisattva names at the close of the passage begins a longer catalogue that continues beyond the excerpt. The Sanskrit equivalents given in parentheses are reconstructed; they are standard identifications found in parallel Sanskrit manuscript traditions of this sūtra.

- The epithet rendered "Subduer of the Two Minds" for Tibetan Yid-gnyis rnam-par-'joms is unusual. The compound likely means one who vanquishes dual-mindedness or doubt (Sanskrit: *Vicikitsāvikrāmin or similar); no Sanskrit attestation is available for certainty, so this rendering follows the literal Tibetan. Mentioned here as a point of genuine lexical uncertainty.

The phrase "lord of the Akaniṣṭha realm" for Mi-mjed-kyi bdag-po Tshangs-pa renders a Brahmā specifically associated with the Akaniṣṭha heaven; some traditions read this as the Brahmā of the realm "below which none are lower," a standard epithet for the pure abodes. Either way the referent is Brahmā as sovereign of his celestial realm.

- The count of buddha-fields in the Blessed One's reply appears to repeat the figure already given in the preceding passage. The Tibetan here reads "brgya stong phrag dgu bcu rtsa dgu gnyis," which is the same as the opening description, so the repetition is deliberate and faithful to the source.

The phrase rendered "dustless, sorrowless awakening" translates byang chub rdul bral mya ngan med pa, literally "awakening free of dust, free of sorrow," a standard compound epithet

for the unsullied nirvāṇic awakening of a buddha.

- The world system name rendered as "Endurance" for Sahā (Tib. mi mjed) follows standard Mahāyāna convention; the Tibetan literally means "Endurance" or "Forbearance," referring to the world where beings endure suffering. Some translators leave it as Sahā; either rendering is defensible, but "Endurance" aids TTS listeners.

The phrase rendered "the bonds of habitual tendency" translates bag chags kyi mtshams sbyor ba, literally "the juncture-linking of habitual tendencies" — a technical phrase indicating the way latent habitual tendencies (vāsanā) bind one to continued afflictive arising. No single standard English phrase covers this precisely; the rendering captures the intended sense.

- The term rendered "superknowledges" is mngon par shes pa (Skt. abhijñā), the five or six higher cognitive powers cultivated in deep meditative concentration. The phrase "wisdom of universal dedication" renders kun tu bsngo ba'i ye shes, meaning the gnosis that knows how to dedicate all merit universally without partiality. The phrase "wisdom that teaches the path" renders lam smra ba'i ye shes, the gnosis of expounding the path. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text; the translation preserves that open ending faithfully.

- The phrase rendered "fear of excessive pride" and "fear of conceit" translates two distinct Tibetan terms: the first, lhag pa'i nga rgyal gyi 'jigs pa, refers to a fear bound up with heightened or inflated pride; the second, rlom sems kyi 'jigs pa, refers to a fear arising from conceit or self-congratulatory arrogance. The distinction is subtle but retained in the translation.

- The phrase rendered "the sphere of self," "the sphere of sentient beings," and "the sphere of awakening" refers to the classical Madhyamaka teaching on the "three spheres" (trimaṇḍala) — giver, recipient, and gift — here recast in a slightly non-standard enumeration. The text as it stands uses "self," "sentient beings," and "awakening" rather than the more familiar "giver, recipient, gift." This is a genuine structural variant and is translated faithfully as the text reads.

The passage ends mid-sentence with "removing desire, ill-will, and" as the Tibetan breaks off there; this is preserved faithfully in the translation.

- The "six recollections" enumerated here are a standard classical list: recollection of the buddhas, the Dharma, the Saṅgha, generosity, moral discipline, and the gods. The text presents them in an unusual order and with bodhisattva-specific rationales attached to each, which is faithful to the source.

The phrase rendered "not assuming a moral demeanor with a mind tainted by material gain" translates a construction meaning that the bodhisattva does not put on the outward appearance of moral conduct while inwardly motivated by desire for material things.

The "nine factors of the resentful mind" and the "nine stations of sentient beings" are standard Abhidharma lists. The nine stations of sentient beings are the nine realms or modes of existence distinguished by form, formlessness, and levels of perception. The nine successively abiding absorptions are the four dhyānas, the four formless absorptions, and the cessation of perception and feeling.

- The phrase rendered as "the ground of taming and vigilance" translates a compound that literally means "having the ground of taming and knowing." The term "knowing" here likely refers to introspective awareness or clear comprehension, functioning alongside taming as a pair foundational to non-recklessness; it is rendered contextually rather than with a technical gloss.

The "four means of attraction" refers to the four bases of gathering disciples: generosity, kind speech, beneficial conduct, and consistency between one's own practice and what one teaches. The Tibetan here has only "the things that attract" without numbering them, though

the tradition standardly counts four; the standard rendering is used.

The phrase rendered as "non-grasping at signs" for "not superimposing" in the second pair of two aspects reflects the Yogācāra-inflected sense of not projecting inherent existence or characteristics onto phenomena; the phrase "not superimposing" would also be defensible.

- The phrase rendered "recollect the overpowering of what has a result" translates "大慈" literally. This is a technical epithet connected to great compassion: compassion is said to be the quality that decisively overcomes the suffering that has its causes and results still intact in sentient beings. The rendering follows the literal syntax; a freer paraphrase might be "the overpowering of what produces results in suffering," but the literal is preserved here.

The phrase "recollect that the crown of the head is not seen" refers to the uṣṇīṣa, one of the major marks of a buddha's body, which is invisible even to beings with divine sight — a sign of inconceivable supremacy. Recollecting this mark is what enables bowing before all beings without pride.

The final sentence is syntactically incomplete in the source as given, ending mid-construction. The translation renders what is present; the passage continues beyond the supplied text.

- The phrase rendered "Lord of Creatures" translates "skye dgu'i bdag po," which is a standard epithet of Brahmā (Prajāpati) in this kind of cosmological list. Since Brahmā appears immediately before it in the Tibetan, the two must be distinct referents; "skye dgu'i bdag po" here most likely refers to Prajāpati or Īśvara as a separate deity. This is a genuine ambiguity in the list.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the Tibetan supplied, and the translation reflects this open ending faithfully.

- The phrase rendered "self-appropriating son" translates 自取之子, which continues the list from the preceding passage. 子 is "son born of semen" or simply "offspring," and in context this is a philosophical view about a self that appropriates a new existence through birth from a seed or semen. The transition from "not one born from a seed" at the end of the preceding passage into "one abides in the view of a self-appropriating son" at the opening of this passage represents a syntactic hinge between the two list items; the rendering follows the established pattern of the series.

The phrase अविज्ञानमभिमता, rendered "the wisdom of direct knowledge," refers to the five or six higher knowledges (*abhijñā*), here described as a form of gnosis inseparable from the bodhisattva's realization.

- The phrase "not giving scriptural transmission through one's own power" renders "不與法寶傳授自他力." The sense is that the buddha or bodhisattva does not transmit teachings arbitrarily through self-will but in accordance with the needs of beings — a nuanced doctrinal point about the non-coercive character of buddha-activity.

The term "branches and sub-branches" for "枝葉" refers to the main and subsidiary divisions of the body in the painter's art, continuing the extended analogy of the royal portrait.

- The phrase rendered "blazing without appropriation" translates a deliberately paradoxical construction in which the bodhisattva is said to engage with the aggregates of appropriation while remaining unbound by them — a standard Mahāyāna antinomy. The repetition of this image later in the passage is intentional and has been preserved.

- The phrase rendered "patience with respect to phenomena that do not arise" translates the technical term for the noble attainment known as anupattikadharmakṣānti, the patience or acceptance that phenomena are without inherent arising, a landmark realization on the

bodhisattva path.

The expression rendered "without remainder" in "liberated their minds from the defilements without remainder" reflects the idiom of liberation free from clinging, not necessarily the Hīnayāna category of nirvāṇa without remainder; the sense here is that their liberation was complete and unattached.

The name Ratnaśikhara, "Jewel Crest" or "Precious Crown," renders the Tibetan gtsug na rin po che, literally "one with a jewel at the crown."

- The phrase rendered "the essential of the body, the essential of wealth and resources, and the essential of livelihood" reflects a list of three "essentials" (snying po, sāra) that a bodhisattva extracts from impermanent things — using the body for Dharma practice, using wealth for generosity, and using one's livelihood in accord with the teaching. The term snying po here carries the sense of "the best use" or "the essence extracted," a standard Mahāyāna idiom.

The closing sentence "he gathers roots of virtue whose very nature is undefiled" translates a line that is syntactically compressed in the Tibetan; the verb sogs pa (literally "to gather" or "to accumulate") concludes the passage abruptly, suggesting this may be a transitional clause leading into a continuation of the text.

- The phrase rendered "view of the transitory collection" translates the technical Madhyamaka and Abhidharma term for the mistaken view that grasps at a self or mine in the psychophysical aggregates; the Tibetan here implies the Sanskrit satkāyadr̥ṣṭi, and the gloss is supplied for the listener's benefit.

The sequence "neither inflated with arrogance nor prostrate with dejection" renders two contrasting terms: the first suggests pride or conceit, the second a kind of self-deprecation or despondency; the translation captures the intended symmetry.

The phrase "he no longer acts and no longer constructs" renders a doubled negation that emphasizes both volitional and constructive mental activity coming to rest; this mirrors a standard formulation for the cessation of saṃskāras at the approach to wisdom.

- The phrase rendered "he does not make a task of it" translates a construction indicating that, having accomplished the cessation of feelings, the bodhisattva does not dwell on or repeat the effort as a self-serving project — a nuance important to the Mahāyāna framing of the passage.
- The final sentence breaks off mid-description, as the Tibetan passage itself ends without completing the thought. This is a deliberate continuity break; the passage continues in the next section.

The phrase rendered "tether of mind" translates a term meaning something like a post or binding-stake to which mind is tied — a traditional image for the way mind is bound or tethered to its own habitual patterns. The rendering preserves the concrete metaphorical force.

- The phrase rendered "true gathering of mind" translates yang dag par 'du ba, which can mean "true assemblage," "correct convergence," or "proper integration" of mind. The precise doctrinal referent here is not entirely transparent; it may indicate the proper unification or concentration of mental factors. This is noted as a genuinely uncertain rendering.

The final sentence is syntactically incomplete in the source passage, trailing off mid-clause, suggesting this is the end of a section that continues in subsequent text.

- The "sixty aspects of the Tathāgata's voice" is a standard enumeration in Mahāyāna literature of the qualities of a buddha's speech. No significant uncertainty attaches to the passage as a whole, but the phrase rendered "uṣṇīṣa on the crown of the head that cannot be seen even by looking" refers to the well-known buddha mark (the top protuberance of the cranium) that is

held to be invisible even when one looks directly for it — an infinite height that escapes vision. This is a standard doctrinal point and requires no emendation.

- The term rendered "the collection of personality views" translates the Sanskrit satkāyadr̥ṣṭi, a technical doctrinal term for the view that grasps at a self or possessions of a self within the five aggregates. Here "近處及遠處," literally "this shore and the far shore," are paired as extremes, and their antidote is given as the dissolution of this fundamental self-grasping view, which is a standard Madhyamaka equation.

The triple negation regarding the eyes — fleshly, divine, and of wisdom — is a structured doctrinal formula: the fleshly eye operates through sign-perception, the divine eye through volitional or karmic formation, and the eye of wisdom through conceptual elaboration; the bodhisattva's vision at this level transcends all three modes.

- The phrase rendered "will become light" translates "yang bar 'gyur," which literally means "to become light or buoyant." This is a technical term in the context of the bases of miraculous power, indicating a quality of mental and physical pliancy or lightness that arises as a result of each of the four factors named. Some translators render this as "will be purified" or "will be refined," but "become light" best captures the classical sense of the meditative quality being cultivated.

- The term rendered "sons of the gods" translates a standard Tibetan expression for divine youths or divine beings within those heavenly realms; it carries no implication of literal offspring and is conventional within cosmological contexts. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, with the list of divine beings continuing beyond what was provided; the translation follows suit.

- The phrase rendered "the concerns of the world" translates a term that literally means "the dharmas of the world" — worldly conditions or preoccupations (gain and loss, fame and disgrace, praise and blame, pleasure and pain). This standard eightfold grouping is implied by the phrase and the rendering reflects that sense.

The passage "bslab pa rnam la ston pa tsam du phang par 'dzin pa" is rendered as regarding those who are trained as a teacher would — meaning one does not assert superiority over them but holds them as if merely their instructor, implying humility. This reading follows the sense of the surrounding ethical list.

- The "sixty-two wrong views" is a standard enumeration in the Pali and Sanskrit canonical literature referring to the spectrum of metaphysical speculations about the self and the world. The Tibetan here follows that established number without elaboration.

The phrase rendered "does not waste" translates a term meaning literally "does not let go to waste" or "does not squander," conveying the sense that mindfulness prevents what has been accumulated or accomplished from being lost through inattention.

• The phrase rendered "the ground of taming, peace, and wisdom" translates "dul ba dang zhi ba dang cang shes kyi sa," where "cang shes" is a somewhat unusual term. It may refer to a ground or stage characterized by subtle discernment or special knowledge, sometimes associated with meditative attainment. The rendering here follows the most natural reading in context.

The phrase "ethical discipline that is motivated by deliberate striving" renders "mngon par 'du byed pa'i tshul khrim," which refers to discipline performed with contrivance or intentional mental fabrication, as opposed to discipline arising naturally from realization. This is a recognized distinction in Mahāyāna ethics.

- The "seven noble treasures" renders nor bdun, the classical list of faith, ethical discipline, moral shame, conscientious fear of wrongdoing, learning, generosity, and wisdom — sometimes called the "seven aryan wealths." The text moves immediately to the seven factors

of awakening (bodhipākṣika dharmas in their sevenfold enumeration), which are here listed with the prefix "right" (yang dag), a standard Tibetan rendering emphasizing the genuine or correct form of each factor.

The "eight grounds of wrong determination" (log pa nyid du nges pa brgyad) refers to the classical list of eight conditions or circumstances that fix beings in wrong views or wrong paths, sometimes called the "eight inopportune states" in a different enumeration; here the context of transcending them via wisdom suggests the eight□□□-type grouping in Abhidharma literature. This is a genuinely uncertain reference and the rendering is provisional.

- The phrase "cultivates the path leading to states of woe, along with the latent tendencies toward existence and non-existence, and is free from all entanglement" is syntactically compressed and doctrinally dense. The passage appears to describe a bodhisattva who, while fully understanding all these things, simultaneously does not practise paths leading to lower rebirths and is free from latent tendencies toward reified existence or non-existence. The Tibetan could be read as a list of things the bodhisattva does not do rather than things accomplished; the conjunction here is ambiguous, and the overall sense points to a bodhisattva who comprehends all levels of conduct without being bound by any of them.

- The passage makes a striking and doctrinally consequential claim: the view of emptiness is placed on equal footing with mistaken views such as the view of self, nihilism, and eternalism. This is a Mahāyāna teaching that emptiness itself, if reified into a fixed object of grasping, becomes just another conceptual view to be abandoned — a point classically associated with the Madhyamaka warning against making emptiness into a thesis or a thing. The word rendered "view of the transitory collection" translates the technical term for the view that takes the five aggregates to be or to belong to a self, which is the root of samsaric bondage in Abhidharma and Madhyamaka analysis.

- The phrase rendered as "those in training" and "those beyond training" refers to āryas who are still on the path of training toward arhatship and those who have completed that training and attained arhatship respectively, a standard Abhidharma distinction. The text uses these as foils to "ordinary persons" throughout the comparative series.

The term rendered as "acquisitiveness" for □□□□□□ is literally "material goods" or "things of value," but in this doctrinal context it carries the sense of clinging to material support or being entangled with possessions; it can also carry the nuance of a kind of reifying grasping. The rendering captures the most natural English equivalent.

The final sentence is a transitional opening into the next topic; the passage breaks off mid-thought, consistent with the instruction to translate only the given passage.

- The phrase rendered "hollow" and "accumulated husks" translates gsob nyid and gsog nyid respectively. These two terms denote something like a chaff or outer shell without inner substance, emphasizing the insubstantiality of constructed phenomena. The pairing is a standard Abhidharma-inflected image and the rendering here follows the doctrinal intent of the passage.

- The phrase rendered "does not fall into definite deliverance" translates a technically precise Mahāyāna doctrinal point: the bodhisattva, even while entering the deepest samādhi and realizing emptiness, deliberately refrains from passing into the nirvāṇa of a śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha, sustaining the bodhisattva vow. The Tibetan "nges par yang mi llung ba" captures this nuance of intentional non-precipitance into individual liberation.

The passage describing mindfulness "not actualizing the fruit directly," even upon attaining the excellent and faultless lineage, similarly refers to the bodhisattva's deliberate deferral of personal liberation in favor of remaining in saṃsāra to serve all sentient beings — a standard Mahāyāna doctrinal theme.

- The Tibetan term "sngon gyi gnas rjes su dran pa" rendered as "recollecting previous abodes" corresponds to Sanskrit pūrvanivāsānusrṃti, one of the standard five or six superknowledges. The list here stops mid-enumeration at the end of the passage, as the Tibetan itself breaks off there. The compound "lha dang mi srog chags" is slightly unusual; it is read as "gods, humans, and living beings" with "srog chags" serving as a broader category inclusive of non-human animate beings.
- The phrase rendered "plays freely with" translates a verb suggesting sporting or ranging through without obstruction, conveying that the bodhisattva exercises the five superknowledges with mastery while simultaneously resting in the wisdom that has exhausted all defilements. The juxtaposition is doctrinally significant: the five superknowledges are here subordinated to and recontextualized by the sixth, the knowledge of exhaustion of defilements, which in this Mahāyāna context is reinterpreted not as the arhat's nirvāṇa but as the bodhisattva's non-abiding wisdom.
- The term rendered "gentleness" (ལྷན་ལྷན་) is unusual in this doctrinal list. It can mean docility, pliancy, or tractability of mind, related to the Sanskrit mṛdutā or sauratya. It occupies a structural position between gnosis and mindfulness in this chain of mutually sustaining qualities. The choice of "gentleness" here is approximate; "pliancy" would be equally defensible.

- The epithet "Universally Delighting All Worlds" renders རྒྱལ་ལོངས་སྤྱོད་པའི་ཡུལ་གྱི་སྤྲོ་བའི་ཡུལ་, which could also be rendered "Delighting in All Worlds" or "Making All Worlds Rejoice." The reading adopted here, "Universally Delighting All Worlds," takes རྒྱལ་ལོངས་སྤྱོད་པའི་ as a causative sense, consistent with how such buddha-names typically function. The alternative transitive reading is equally defensible.
- The compound "འབྲུག་སྐྱེལ་ལྗང་ལྗང་གི་འཕྲུལ་སྤྲོ་བའི་ཡུལ་" literally means "heartwood of the sandalwood serpent." This likely refers to a legendary or paradisiacal variety of sandalwood described in buddhist cosmological literature, sometimes understood as sandalwood of surpassing quality associated with nāga serpents. The precise nature of this substance is a genuine uncertainty; it may also be rendered "nāga-sandalwood heartwood," but "sandalwood serpent heartwood" reflects the literal Tibetan.

- The name rendered throughout as Ratnaśara is the Sanskrit reconstruction of ར་རྩ་ཤ་ར་, meaning "Jewel-meteor" or "Meteor of the Precious One." The Tathāgata's name Sarvalokābhīrata reconstructs from ས་ར་བཀོད་ལ་མི་ར་ཏ་, "Delighting All Worlds." The phrase "acceptance concordant with phenomena" renders འཕགས་པའི་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་མཆོད་པ་, the anulomikī kṣānti, a standard Mahāyāna term for the patient acceptance that accords with the nature of all phenomena, considered a significant meditative attainment. The passage ends mid-list, reflecting where the supplied Tibetan breaks off.
- The epithet of the Tathāgata, rendered here as "Sarvalokābhīrata" (the Tathāgata who delights all worlds), translates the Tibetan ས་ར་བཀོད་ལ་མི་ར་ཏ་. This Sanskrit reconstruction is standard for this buddha-name in the relevant corpus.

The phrase rendered "the door-frame of ignorance" translates a compound meaning literally "the hollow of the doorpost of ignorance" — a vivid image of shattering the very frame or cavity through which ignorance enters.

- The "four means of gathering disciples" refers to the four bases of attraction or social bonds (Skt. saṃgrahavastu): generosity, pleasing speech, beneficial conduct, and consistency of purpose. Their individual enumeration earlier in the passage serves to show that different beings respond to each one differently, even separately from the others. This is a well-known Mahāyāna doctrinal category and the translation reflects the standard rendering.
- The phrase "exhorting others at the right time and the wrong time alike" renders the Tibetan "dus dang dus ma yin par skul ba," which literally means urging or exhorting whether it is the appropriate moment or not. This conveys the bodhisattva's tireless, unconditional effort to rouse beings regardless of circumstance, and is a recognized quality in the literature rather than an error in the text.
- The repeated enumeration of gatehouses entered at intervals of thousands of years is a deliberate literary device in the original, and the translation preserves it with fidelity. The Tibetan term bstims, here rendered "examined," carries the sense of testing or canvassing a group; the image is of the Tathāgata formally calling for volunteers. The phrase "from atop a seat they will not even yield to you" renders the idiom of being refused even a seat, which is a pointed social insult in the Indian context the text presupposes.
- The phrase rendered "attained concordant patience" translates rjes 'thun bzod pa thob, referring to a specific level of doctrinal realization — the "patience concordant with the Dharma" (anulomikī kṣānti), a stage on the path of preparation where the practitioner gains a tolerance for the deep truths of emptiness. This is a technical term in Mahāyāna path-literature and the rendering preserves that precision.
- The phrase rendered as "the unseen summit of the head" refers to the uṣṇīṣa, the cranial protuberance that is among the major marks of a great being, specifically the aspect of it that is invisible and immeasurable even to other buddhas. The Tibetan "འཇམ་མཁའ་ལྷན་པོའི་ལྷན་པོ་" literally means "the crown of the head that is invisible when looked upon," which is the standard referent for this mark. This has significant doctrinal import as one of the supreme physical characteristics of a buddha.
- The "triple defilement" rendered from "dri gsum dri ma spangs" refers to the three defilements of attachment, aversion, and delusion, which is standard doctrinal usage.

The phrase rendered "the dust of darkness" combines two images in the Tibetan: darkness (mun pa) and dust (rdul), both as metaphors for affliction and obscurations. These are kept as a compound image since the verse form supports it.

- The epithets of the buddha Jewel-Arising rendered here follow the standard list of ten buddha-epithets (daśanāma). The phrase translated "guide of persons to be tamed" renders the Sanskrit damyaśārathi, literally "charioteer of persons to be tamed."

The closing passage on the dhāraṇī of vajra-words and the syllable "A" is doctrinally dense and its final sentence is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan. The rendering "word of clear discernment" for rnam par rig pa'i tshig reflects the sense that this single inexhaustible syllable is the utterance through which all meaning is distinctly known; an alternative rendering would be "the word of full cognition."

- The name Ratnaśikhara is the Sanskrit reconstruction of रत्नशिखरा, meaning "Precious Crest" or "Jewel Topknot." It is used here consistently with prior rendering.

The phrase འཇམ་མཁའ་ལྷན་པོའི་ལྷན་པོ་ at the close is a standard tripartite Vinaya-style injunction to memorize, retain, and bear in mind a teaching. The three imperatives rendered here as "Take up," "Master," and "Uphold" represent the conventional doctrinal meaning of receiving,

learning thoroughly, and carrying forward a scriptural transmission.

- The closing colophon names Kamalaśīla (the well-known 8th–9th century Indian paṇḍita) as the Indian abbot and Dharmataśīla as the Tibetan lotsāwa, placing this translation in the later Tibetan canonical revision period. The phrase "new translation style" refers to the standardized vocabulary reforms introduced during the imperial and post-imperial translation projects.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.